IELTS ACADEMIC READING

Volume 9

9 complete Academic Reading tests — three full passages and 40 questions each — with a complete answer key and passage evidence for every answer

IB

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9	360	Full
FULL TESTS	QUESTIONS	ANSWER KEY

Created by Teacher: Ibodullaev Bekhruz

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Introduction

Welcome to **IELTS Academic Reading — Volume 9**, a printable practice book of 9 complete Reading tests, compiled and prepared by Teacher Ibodullaev Bekhruz.

Every test follows the real exam format: three passages of increasing difficulty and 40 questions covering the full range of IELTS question types — True/False/Not Given, Matching Headings, Matching Information, Multiple Choice, Summary and Sentence Completion, and more. Answer circles and blank lines are left for you to write your answers, just like on test day.

Part One contains all 9 tests with questions only, so you can practise without seeing any answers. **Part Two** contains the complete Answer Key for each test, with the keywords from each question and the exact sentence in the passage that proves the correct answer.

How to use this book:

- Sit each test in one go, under timed conditions — 60 minutes for all three passages.
- Write your answers directly in the circles and blanks provided.
- Check your answers in Part Two and read the passage evidence for every question you got wrong.
- Use the band-score table on the answer key pages to estimate your result, then revisit weak question types.

Good luck with your preparation, and follow **@bekhruzposts** for more free IELTS materials.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 1

Volume 9 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

The Baobabs of Madagascar

The ancient baobabs of Madagascar are some of the largest and most distinctive trees in the world, but they face an uncertain future.

The island of Madagascar in the Indian Ocean is the best place in the world to see baobabs. These spectacular trees, with their massive trunks and distinctive horizontal root-like branches, can live over 800 years. Of the eight known species, six are found only there, while a seventh has made its way across the Mozambique Channel from mainland Africa with a certain amount of human help. Some of the most visited and photographed baobabs in Madagascar are at the Avenue des Baobabs in the western province of Menabe, close to the town of Morondava. There, a dozen trees straddle a narrow sandy road, soaring 30 metres into the sky. Known as renala - 'mother of the forest' - in the local Malagasy* language, these trees belong to the tallest baobab species in the world: Adansonia grandidieri, named after two great 19th-century French botanists, Michel Adanson and Alfred Grandidier.

Baobabs have religious and spiritual significance for many Malagasy tribes, although the majority of the island's population will probably never see one - they only grow along the western margin of the island and not in the more populous central highlands. However, as the national tree and the national emblem, the trees are an ideal symbol for increasing awareness not only of the endangered forests, but also of the traditional beliefs of the people who live alongside them. But what does the future hold for the Malagasy baobabs?

The Avenue des Baobabs is something of a contradiction; the 'natural' scene that tourists visit is actually man-made. While the trees themselves are natural enough, the surrounding landscape was created by humans. Back in the early 20th century, much of the Morondava plain was cleared for rice and sugar-cane fields. However, many baobabs were spared because they are valuable as a food source and renewable building material, or they simply survived the fires that were set to clear the dry deciduous forest around them. These days many stand alone in fields, a reminder of where the forest once was. But now it seems that even the mighty baobabs are falling down. 'Every year I see new trees that have fallen,' says Jim Bond, an ethnobotanist who has studied Madagascar's baobabs for more than a decade. The exact cause of the falling baobabs is uncertain, but some people think that the water used to irrigate the nearby fields is partly to blame. Baobabs are adapted to

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the annual wet season, but their roots can't cope with constantly waterlogged soils. Lone trees separated from the surrounding forest are also susceptible to cyclones, which reach speeds of over 200 kph in the area, and can easily uproot even a 30-metre baobab.

Baobabs elsewhere on the island are also facing a host of threats, with three of the six native species now listed as endangered by the World Conservation Union. David Baum from the University of Wisconsin has spent years researching Malagasy baobabs. 'The main threat to their survival is land clearance for farming, which probably suppresses regeneration,' he says. Burning is the usual method of clearing land, and while baobabs have some resistance to this, they will eventually succumb to repeated burning. Human disturbance in the forest, such as logging, is also a problem. This practice may be promoting the rapid spread of shrubby undergrowth, which quickly fills in the bright forest gaps needed for baobab germination. Another problem the trees face is the dispersal of their seeds. Baum suggests that dispersal is being limited by the absence of two large, now extinct animals - a gorilla-sized lemur and the three-metre-tall elephant bird. Passage through the digestive tract of these giant fruit-eating animals probably once played a vital role in the distribution of the renala baobabs in particular.

The Malagasy government is becoming increasingly concerned as the baobab is key to the local tourism industry, and thus to the economy of the island as a whole. But visiting and photographing the solitary trees in the dramatic open landscape at the Avenue des Baobabs isn't the only way to experience baobabs in Madagascar. Within a few hours' drive of Morondava, three species of baobab can be seen in largely intact, dry forest habitat. Jim Bond has led expeditions of Malagasy and foreign participants to the Mikea forest in the island's southwest, which is almost certainly one of the least studied and least damaged areas of baobab forest left in Madagascar. On his expeditions Bond works closely with local people to search for, and create maps of baobab distribution. He also plans to compile an illustrated children's book of the many local folk-tales about the tree, hoping that national and international versions will help to spread the word about how important baobabs are in Malagasy culture. But it's going to require some swift and coordinated action to ensure that the baobab becomes a symbol of conservation success, rather than a symbol of humanity's mistakes.

** Malagasy: of Madagascar*

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Questions 1–6

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1? Write **TRUE**, **FALSE** *or* **NOT GIVEN**.

1 All of the baobab species found on Madagascar are unique to the island.

2 Adanson and Grandidier were the first foreign botanists to visit Madagascar.

3 The baobab can be found in most areas of Madagascar.

4 The landscape around the Avenue des Baobabs is the result of agricultural development.

5 Jim Bond is certain about what is causing baobabs in the Morondava area to fall.

6 There is general agreement about the reasons for baobabs falling down.

Questions 7–13

Complete the notes below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Baobabs Under Threat

REASONS WHY MADAGASCAR'S BAOBABS ARE DECLINING IN NUMBER

Morondava area

- trees may be falling down because of 7 ——— from nearby fields
- lone trees are at risk from 8 ———

Forest areas

- land clearance: mainly by burning carried out to create space for 9 ——— activity
- practice of 10 ——— makes seed germination difficult
- disappearance of certain 11 ——— which dispersed baobab seeds

Jim Bond's efforts to record information about the baobab

- making 12 ——— of areas of relatively undamaged baobab forest
- producing a 13 ——— showing importance of baobab in local culture

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Reading Passage 2

Coins — The First Form of Money

A Few people pay much attention to coins; we take them for granted. Since the advent of paper currency and the abandonment of a monetary system based on intrinsic or actual value, they have been demoted to the status of change: what is left when you have paid for something with 'paper' money. There is even a belief that they will one day be obsolete, as will paper or plastic notes, and money will at last have achieved the pure status of a mathematical formulation, a system of electronic credits and debits.

B In the modern media environment, the sheer number of visual images is overwhelming, but it makes one stop to think that coins are among the most durable of our artefacts, and future archaeologists will scrutinise coins in order to learn about their distant ancestors. This is exactly the way ancient coins have informed us for over four millennia. There are thousands of different coins, each designed to carry meaning as well as value, tiny but rich sources of documentary evidence about events and cultural attitudes, frequently produced with exquisite craftsmanship.

C Coins in Europe date from 2,500 to 2,700 years ago, and seem to have originated in the ancient kingdom of Lydia, in what is now Turkey. Before coins, trade was based on barter: the direct trade of commodities. Barter required the physical presence of both commodities that were being traded. Metal coins were far more portable, and not subject to the same spoilage on long sea journeys as a commodity like grain might be if it became wet. However, they could also be accumulated, and these hoards could be stolen. Coins were therefore a temptation to criminals. The Greeks, however, were the first to realise the full potential of the new invention. They were a trading people of seafarers. Their civilisation, which was composed of dozens of city-states, was highly decentralised. Despite the potential for theft, the Greeks realised that they could benefit enormously from a system that used coins, because it meant that they no longer had to carry goods with them to barter.

D The value of coins was generally based on the intrinsic value of the metal they were made of. At first this was mostly silver, and this meant that the discovery of silver mines on Greek territory actually increased the quantity of money they could produce. Had the Greek mining been on a larger scale, it could have caused problems similar to those faced by the Spanish centuries later, when so much gold from the New World was brought into their economy that it resulted in serious inflation. One advantage of intrinsic value was that coins could be weighed to determine the amount of metal they contained, so that the only thing an issuing state had to guarantee was the purity of the metal to prevent accusations of fraud and cheating, which could cause fighting and unrest. This was quite

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difficult to do, especially with coins made of gold, until Archimedes realised that different metals have different weight-volume ratios, and that by measuring the amount of displacement when coins were immersed in water, it was possible to establish whether gold was alloyed with silver.

E All ancient coins were made by hand using engraved metal moulds. Many hundreds of coins were made, and as a result the moulds often cracked and new ones had to be engraved. This explains the endless variety encountered in coins with the same designs because the moulds had to be remade repeatedly, by many different artisans. One of the distinctive features of coins, in fact, is that they are the work of anonymous craftsmen, and yet each coin is an intimate reflection of the character of its city of origin. It was the Greeks who realised that coins could have a double function, as a unit of value and as a symbol of the identity of the city that issued them. The Greek view of life was deeply motivated by a spirit of competition, and coins, which circulated around the trading world, were a way of advertising the qualities of each particular city-state.

F Interestingly, Greek coins from the city of Athens, which was the home of the greatest sculptors of the classical period, seem to have been completely disconnected from the high sculptural tradition. The beautiful features of the city's patron, Athena (with her owl on the reverse of the coin), seem to have been repeated virtually unaltered for many years. Perhaps this was because the Athenian currency had grown increasingly to be the international standard and, like the US dollar today, a uniform design implied integrity.

G One side of a coin was always occupied by the head of a divinity, so it was a relatively small step, at around 323 BC, for Greek coins to replace that head with the portrait of the reigning monarch, a tradition that has continued in monarchies to the present day. Republics may have either symbolic heads - going back to the older tradition of divinities - or the features of a distinguished past head of state. The Romans adopted the Greek practice of coin design and as a result, the features of many great Romans have survived and are known to modern generations, despite the fact that the art of portrait painting was completely lost for more than a millennium following the fall of the Roman Empire.

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Questions 14–20

Reading Passage 2 has seven paragraphs, **A–G**. *Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.*

LIST OF HEADINGS

i Training coin makers
ii A form of regional promotion
iii More gold than silver in Greece
iv Calculating what a coin was worth
v A simpler, more efficient way of trading
vi Putting a face to famous historical names
vii An uncertain future
viii Careless workmanship caused breakages
ix Unchanging coins signalled trustworthiness
x Reading the writing on coins
xi Significant records of past societies

Q	Paragraph	Answer
14	Paragraph A	
15	Paragraph B	
16	Paragraph C	
17	Paragraph D	
18	Paragraph E	
19	Paragraph F	
20	Paragraph G	

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Questions 21 and 22

Choose **TWO** *letters, A–E. Which* **TWO** *of these comments about ancient coins are made by the writer of the text?*

A There is no record of the names of the coin makers.
B Coins were not popular as payment for traded objects.
C Coins with the same design often looked quite different.
D Greek coins were more beautiful in design than Roman coins.
E At times, too many coins were produced in Greece.

Questions 23–26

Complete the summary below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Greek Traders and Coins

The ancient Greek (23) _____ was made up of many city-states which were spread over a large area. Many Greeks were seafarers who travelled the seas trading. Before coins, they had to do this through (24) _____. This meant that, whenever they set out, they had to carry a lot of goods, which could get damaged on the voyages. The Greeks liked coins; they were made of metal, and the weather and sea had little effect on them. The Greeks had a plentiful supply of (25) _____ which they mined themselves, but were able to avoid the problem of (26) _____ which the Spanish encountered much later, after they allowed too much gold from the New World to enter their economy.

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Reading Passage 3

Creating a Better Grapefruit

By blocking the right taste receptors, biotech researchers turn bitter into sweet.

A There is a reason why grapefruit juice is served in little glasses. Most people don't want to drink more than a few ounces at a time. This is because a natural chemical compound found in grapefruit, naringin, has a bitter taste. Some people like that bitterness in small doses and believe it enhances the general flavour, but others would rather avoid it altogether. So juice packagers often select grapefruit with low naringin content, even though the compound has antioxidant properties that some nutritionists contend may help prevent many serious diseases.

B It is possible, however, to get the goodness of grapefruit without the bitter taste. In a test conducted by a biotechnology company, sets of two miniature white paper cups, labelled 304 and 305, were placed before five people seated around a conference table. Each person drank from one cup and then the other, cleansing their palates between tastes with water and a cracker. Even the smallest sip of 304 had grapefruit's unmistakeable bite. But 305 was smoother; there was the sour taste of citrus but none of the bitterness of naringin. This juice had been treated with AMP, a compound that blocks the bitterness in foods without making them less nutritious.

C Taste research is a booming business these days, with scientists delving into all five basics: sweet, bitter, sour, salty, and umami (the savory taste of protein). However, bitterness is of special interest to the food industry because it is present in so many different types of food. There are thousands of bitter-tasting compounds in nature. They defend plants by warning animals away and protect animals by letting them know when a plant may be poisonous. But the system isn't foolproof. Grapefruit and bitter green vegetables like Brussels sprouts and kale are nutritious despite - and sometimes because of - their bitter-tasting components.

D 'Humans are the only species that enjoys a bitter taste,' says Charles Zuker, a neuroscientist at the University of California School of Medicine at San Diego. 'Every other species is averse to bitter because it means bad news. But we have learned to enjoy it. We drink coffee, which is bitter, and quinine (in tonic water) too. We enjoy having that spice in our lives.' Because bitterness can be pleasant in small quantities but repellent when intense, bitter blockers like AMP could make a whole range of foods, drinks and medicines more palatable.

E People have varying capacities for tasting bitterness and the differences appear to be genetic. About 75% of people are sensitive to the taste of some well-identified bitter compounds. Those who are sensitive seem to be less likely than others to eat bitter

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vegetables, according to Stephen Wooding, a geneticist at the University of Utah. Some people who have an unusually high number of taste buds, and are known as 'supertasters', are especially sensitive to these compounds. Supertasters tend to shun all kinds of bitter-tasting things, including vegetables, coffee, and dark chocolate.

F The tongue is covered with taste buds. Under the microscope each one looks like an onion, consisting of 50 to 100 elongated cells running from the top of the taste buds to the bottom. At the top is a group of receptors that captures the taste molecules, known as tastants, in food and drink. The receptors function much like those for sight and smell. Once a bitter signal has been received, it is relayed via proteins known as G proteins. The G protein involved in the perception of bitterness, sweetness and umami was identified in the early 1990s by Robert Margolskee, at Mount Sinai School of Medicine in New York. The protein triggers a cascade of chemical reactions that lead to ion concentrations within the cell. Ultimately, this delivers a signal to the brain that registers as bitter.

G Once they understood the taste mechanism, scientists began to think of ways to interfere with it. They tried AMP, an organic compound found in breast milk and other substances, that is created as cells break down food. AMP has no bitterness of its own, but when put in foods, as Margolskee and his colleagues discovered, it attaches to bitter-taste receptors. As effective as it is, AMP may not be able to dampen every type of bitter taste because it probably doesn't attach to all 30 bitter-taste receptors.

H Some taste researchers believe that, in time, compounds like AMP will help make processed foods less unhealthy. Consider, for example, that a single cup of canned chicken noodle soup contains 850 milligrams of sodium chloride, or table salt - more than a third of the recommended daily allowance. The salt masks the bitterness created by the high temperatures used in the canning process, which cause sugars and amino acids to react. Part of the table salt could be replaced by another type of salt, potassium chloride, which tends to be scarce in some people's diets because of its bitter taste. But that bitter taste could be eliminated with a dose of AMP. Bitter blockers could also be used in place of sugary cherry and grape flavourings in children's cough syrups, and they could dampen the bitterness of drugs like antihistamines, antibiotics and other similar products.

I A number of foodmakers have already begun to experiment with AMP in their products, and other bitter blockers are being developed. In a few years, perhaps, after food companies have taken the bitterness from canned soup and improved the taste of medicines, they can set their sights on something more useful: a bitter blocker in a bottle that any of us can sprinkle on our Brussels sprouts or stir into our grapefruit juice.

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Questions 27–33

Reading Passage 3 has nine paragraphs, **A–I**. *Which paragraph contains the following information? NB You may use any letter more than once.*

Q	Statement	Answer
27	details of an experiment in taste comparison	
28	examples of medications that could be improved using compounds that remove bitterness	
29	a biological reason why some people don't like bitter-tasting foods	
30	an explanation of how the taste process works	
31	why bitterness is more interesting commercially than other tastes	
32	an example of how compounds that remove bitterness could indirectly benefit health	
33	a reason why people have different taste preferences from animals	

Questions 34–38

Complete the sentences below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

The grapefruit used to make drinks is chosen because it contains a smaller amount of a substance called (34) _____

Animals associate a bitter taste with (35) _____ plants.

Our varying degree of sensitivity to bitter tastes is thought to be (36) _____

People who are extremely aware of bitter tastes are called (37) _____

Receptors inside the (38) _____ on the tongue detect the taste of food and drink.

Questions 39 and 40

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**.

(39) The G protein identified by Robert Margolskee

A is responsible for transmitting bitter tastes.

B causes dangerous reactions in the cells of the tongue.

C has a similar function to sight and smell receptors.

D can be found only in sweetness and umami.

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40 AMP is an organic compound which is

A found only in breast milk.

B bitter-tasting when added to food.

C able to reduce some bitter tastes.

D found in bitter taste receptors.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 2

Volume 9 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Andrew Carnegie: Industrialist and Philanthropist

The Scottish-born American industrialist and philanthropist Andrew Carnegie, who was the leader of the American steel industry from 1873 to 1901, donated large sums of his fortune to educational, cultural, and scientific institutions. He was born in 1835 in Scotland, the son of William Carnegie, a weaver, and Margaret Morrison Carnegie.

With the invention of weaving machines, William Carnegie's job disappeared, and eventually the family was forced into poverty. In 1848 the family left Scotland and settled in Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, in the USA. William found a job in a cotton factory, but he soon quit to return to his home handloom, making linens and trying to sell them door-to-door. Andrew Carnegie also worked in the cotton factory, but after his father died in 1855, his strong desire to help take care of the family pushed him to educate himself. He became an avid reader, a theatergoer, and a lover of music.

Andrew Carnegie became a messenger boy in a telegraph office and later became a telegraph operator. Thomas A. Scott, superintendent of the western division of the Pennsylvania Railroad, made the eighteen-year-old his secretary. Carnegie was soon earning enough to buy a house for his mother. During the Civil War in the United States (1861–65), he helped organize the military telegraph system, but soon returned to Pittsburgh to take Scott's old job with the railroad.

Between 1865 and 1870 Carnegie made money through investments in several small iron mills and factories. He also traveled throughout England, selling the bonds of small United States railroads and bridge companies. Carnegie began to see that steel was eventually going to replace iron for the manufacture of rails, structural shapes, pipe, and wire. In 1873 he organized a steel rail company and continued building by cutting prices, driving out competitors, shaking off weak partners, and putting earnings back into the company. He never went public (sold shares of his company in order to raise money). Instead he obtained capital from profit, and when necessary from banks, and he kept on growing, making heavy steel alone.

In the 1880s Carnegie's purchases included a majority stake in the H C Frick Company in Pennsylvania that had vast coal interests, and also the Homestead mills business. Frick became his partner and eventually chairman of the Carnegie Company. Carnegie had moved to New York City in 1867 to be close to the marketing centers for steel products,

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while Frick stayed in Pennsylvania as the general manager. They made a good team. Behind the scenes, Carnegie planned new projects and the improvement of existing plants; Frick was the working director who watched over the mass-production programs that helped keep price down.

Carnegie spent his leisure time traveling. He also wrote several books, including Triumphant Democracy (1886), which pointed out what he thought were the advantages of life in the United States over the unequal societies of Britain and other European countries. To Carnegie, access to education was the key to America's political stability and industrial accomplishments. In 1889 he published an article, 'Wealth', stating his belief that the rich had a duty to use their money to improve the welfare of the community.

Carnegie remained a bachelor until his mother died in 1886. A year later he married Louise Whitfield and they had one child together. The couple began to spend six months each year in Scotland, though Carnegie kept an eye on business developments and problems.

Carnegie's absence from the United States was a factor in the Homestead mills strike of 1892. After acquiring Homestead, Carnegie had invested in new plants and equipment, increased production, and automated many of the mill's operations, cutting down the number of workers that were needed. Carnegie believed that workers had a right to join unions and to bargain with management through their unions. He also recognized the right to strike, as long as the action was conducted peacefully. He viewed strikes as trials of strength, with peaceful discussion resolving the conflict. In contract talks during 1892, Frick wanted to lower the minimum wage because of the need for fewer workers. The union representing his workers would not accept this and organized a strike.

Following a violent confrontation that resulted in the death of eight workers, soldiers were sent in to restore order and Carnegie was criticized for his lack of action. In the 1890s Carnegie also began to meet with tougher competition from newer, bigger companies who were interested in controlled prices and sharing the market. Companies that he had sold to for years threatened to cut down their purchases unless he agreed to cooperate. These threats made him decide to fight back. He refused to enter into any agreements with other companies. Moreover, he decided to invade their territories by making similar products and by expanding his sales activities into the west of the country. Eventually, though, he decided to sell his company to the newly formed U.S. Steel Corporation in 1901 for almost $500 million. Carnegie's personal share was $225 million.

In retirement, Carnegie began to set up trust funds 'for the improvement of mankind'. He built some three thousand public libraries all over the English-speaking world and funded galleries, museums and concert halls in the US. He also built a group of technical schools, a

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research institute, and a foundation providing pensions for university professors. When Carnegie died in 1919, the continuation of his broad interests was put under the general charge of the Carnegie Corporation, with a donation of $125 million.

Questions 1–7

Complete the notes below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Carnegie's Life

1835–1855

- found employment in the same workplace as his (1) _____
- educated himself through books, theatrical performances and (2) _____

1855–1865

- worked in a telegraph office
- became (3) _____ to Thomas A Scott at Pennsylvania Railroad

1865–1870

- made investments in the US and England
- realised that changing engineering needs would require a greater demand for (4) _____

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1873

- managed a rail manufacturing business by:
- reducing (5) ———
- restructuring
- reinvesting profit and sometimes borrowing money from (6) ———

1880S

- Frick and Carnegie became partners
- Carnegie's responsibilities: arranging future (7) ——— and innovations for factories
- Frick's responsibilities: Production

Questions 8–13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage? Write **TRUE**, **FALSE** *or* **NOT GIVEN**.

(8) Carnegie believed that the USA offered more opportunities than European countries did.

(9) A smaller workforce was required at the Homestead factory after Carnegie took control.

(10) Carnegie prevented his workers from joining unions.

(11) Carnegie blamed Frick for the violent workers' strike in 1892.

(12) In the 1890s Carnegie negotiated with his competitors.

(13) Carnegie's provision of funds for libraries was limited to those in the United States.

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Reading Passage 2

Translating: A Key to International Understanding?

A The term 'translation' is used for all cases where the meaning of expressions in one language (the 'source' language) is turned into the meaning in another (the target language), whether the medium is spoken, written, or signed. In specific professional contexts, however, a distinction is drawn between work with the spoken or signed language (interpreting), and work with the written language (translating), although certain tasks blur this distinction.

B It is sometimes said that there is no task more complex than translation - a claim that can be readily believed when all the variables involved are taken into account. Translators not only need to know their source language well; they must also have a thorough understanding in the field of knowledge covered by the source text, and of any social, cultural, or emotional connotations that need to be specified in the target language if the intended effect is to be conveyed. The same special awareness needs to be present for the target language, so that points of special phrasing, contemporary fashions in expression, local expectations, and so on, can all be taken into account. On the whole, translators work into their mother tongue (or language of habitual use), to ensure a result that sounds as natural as possible though some translators have argued that, for certain types of text (e.g., scientific material) where translation accuracy is more crucial than naturalness, it makes more sense for the translators to be more fluent in the source language.

C The aim of translation is to provide semantic equivalence between source and target language. This is what makes translation different from other linguistic activities, such as adapting, precise writing, and abstracting. However, there are many problems hidden within this apparently simple statement, all to do with what standards of 'equivalence' should be expected and accepted.

D Exact equivalence is of course impossible: no translator could provide a translation that was a perfect parallel to the source text, in such respects as rhythm, puns and cultural allusions. Such a parallel is not even possible when paraphrasing within a single language: there is always some loss of information.

E On the other hand, there are many kinds of inexact equivalence, any of which can be successful at a certain level of practical functioning. It therefore follows that there is no such thing as a best translation. The success of translation depends on the purpose for which it was made, which in turn reflects the needs of the people for whom it was made. A rough and-ready translation of a letter can suffice to inform a firm of the nature of an enquiry. A translation of a scientific article requires careful attention to meaning but little attention to stylistic features. The provision of a dubbed film script will warrant scrupulous

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care over the synchronisation of lip movements, often at the expense of content. Literary work requires a sensitive consideration of form as well as content, and may prompt several translations, each of which emphasises a different aspect of the original. It is easy to see what might be 'best' for one set of circumstances may be entirely unsuitable for another.

F Several different kinds of translation have been proposed to allow for this range of possibilities. A pragmatic translation emphasises accuracy and knowledge of the subject, required for instruction manuals and much scientific research. In an aesthetic translation, important for literary material, the focus is on preserving the emotional as well as the cognitive content of the work, and on maintaining some level of stylistic equivalence. Ethnographic or sociolinguistic translations aim to pay full attention to the cultural backgrounds of the authors and the recipients, and take into account differences between source and target language, and the ways of life in which they are embedded. And there are various kinds of linguistic translation, where the aim is to convey the structural flavour of the original text, often in quite a literal manner, emphasising such features as archaisms, dialecticisms, and levels of formality. Most translations, of course, are mixtures of these theoretical types, reflecting the complex reality of language in use.

G At another level, in a word-for-word translation each word in the source language is translated by a word in the target language. The result often makes no sense, especially when idiomatic constructions are used. In a literal translation the linguistic structure of the source text is followed, but is normalised according to the rules of the target language. In a free translation the linguistic structure of the source language is ignored, and an equivalent is found based on the meaning it conveys.

H Translators aim to produce a text that is as faithful to the original as circumstances require or permit, and yet that reads as if it were written originally in the target language. They aim to be "invisible people" - transferring content without drawing attention to the considerable artistic and technical skills involved in the process. The complexity of the task is apparent, but its importance is often underestimated, and its practitioners' social status and legal rights undervalued. Some countries view translation as a menial, clerical task, and pay their translators accordingly, while others regard it as a major intellectual discipline in its own right. The question of status is currently much debated, particularly in Europe, where demand for translators is rocketing, especially in relation to the European Union.

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Questions 14 and 15

Reading Passage 2 has eight paragraphs, **A–H**. *Which paragraph contains the following information?*

Q	Statement	Answer
14	the effect that a client's requirements have on the nature of a translation	
15	contrasting attitudes towards translators	

Questions 16–19

Complete the summary below. Write **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** *from paragraphs C, D and E for each answer.*

The Goal of Translation

Translation is an attempt to create a text in the target language which displays (16) _____ with a source text. It is inevitable that not all information can be conveyed, however, so translations are best judged according to their (17) _____, for example, the translator of a business letter or scientific text does not need to consider its (18) _____ aspects while someone dubbing a film may give a relatively low value to (19) _____.

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Questions 20–23

Look at the following features of translating and the types of translation below. Match each feature with the correct type of translation, **A–F**.

TYPES OF TRANSLATION

A aesthetic
B ethnographic
C free
D literal
E pragmatic
F word-for-word

Q	Feature	Answer
20	focuses on reproducing the content accurately	
21	looks at important cultural aspects of language use	
22	follows the original grammatical structures as required by the target language	
23	focuses on meaning without necessarily using the original grammatical structures	

Questions 24–26

Choose **THREE** *letters, A–F. Which* **THREE** *of the following points are mentioned by the writer of the passage?*

A The objectives of translating are always clearly different from those of interpreting.
B A translator may need to consider the culture of the target language.
C Translation is an activity which requires professional training.
D It is difficult to specify what constitutes a very good translation.
E The skill required for translation is increasingly gaining recognition.
F A translation should give the impression of being an original work.

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Reading Passage 3

The Mystery of Easter Island

What could possibly explain the lack of vegetation on Easter Island?

The giant stone statues of Easter Island in the Pacific Ocean have perplexed archaeologists ever since European explorers first witnessed them three centuries ago. Jacob Roggeveen, the Dutch seaman who gave the island its name in 1722, was amazed by the statues, each of which clearly weighed several tonnes. But as there were no forests on the island, he could not comprehend how people devoid of heavy timber could build and erect something that size. It was also remarkable considering the absence of metal objects for carving and cutting, and the reliance on mere human strength as no draught animals could be seen either. Roggeveen was equally amazed as to how the islanders could have come to colonise such a remote place. Their canoes were leaky and frail, not the sort of ocean-going craft that could survive a three-week sea journey. At the time of his visit, it seemed evident the islanders were living in extremely poor conditions and that there was no cultivation of crops.

What was the mystery behind the statues? In the 1970s, the author Erich von Däniken suggested the statues were the work of extraterrestrial beings. It was hard to believe the stones were the work of humans who were more than 2,000 miles from the nearest mainland, so for a short period of time his theory appealed to those fascinated with space travel. But for serious academics, the puzzle of the statues has caused a deep divide. Some archaeologists see Easter Island as an example of what can happen when the lust for material splendour - ever bigger stone carvings in this case - is satisfied at the expense of the environment. Others, meanwhile, take a different view. The island, these scholars argue, suffered at the hands of introduced diseases, notably smallpox, and a slave trade that stole a huge proportion of its indigenous population. At the heart of the debate is the issue of the island's deforestation. There is no doubt that the island was once covered in palm trees. There is also no doubt that something happened that caused the island to become completely denuded over a short period of time. But was it the islanders who triggered this environmental degradation or another event beyond their control, such as the introduction of rats? It is an indisputable fact that rats found their way to the island, although exactly how is a matter of debate.

In 2005, the anthropologist Jared Diamond claimed the islanders started building ceremonial statues in an atmosphere of rivalry between the many clans. To move the statues from the island's quarry in the south-east, they needed to cut large logs for the construction of long 'canoe ladders' to carry them to the coast. For its transport alone, each statue would have required several trees to be cut down. As a result of the deforestation, Diamond believes food production fell dramatically. Consequently the population

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collapsed from perhaps as many as 15,000 to the few thousand that were eking out a living by the time Roggeveen arrived. Smallpox and slavery killed off those who remained, but the islanders were on the way to total collapse even without any European contact, says Diamond.

But not everyone is convinced. Professor Terry Hunt, an anthropologist at the University of Hawaii, says: 'There is no evidence that a population collapse occurred before European contact.' He is supported by Professor Carl Lipo of California State University. They argue that Easter Island was colonised by the first Polynesian seafarers nowhere near as early as supposed. They say the first people to arrive came around AD1200, about 400 years later than other scientists have suggested from radio-carbon dating. This makes it implausible for the population to have reached the 15,000 figure that would have caused such a fast ecocide. They also believe the deforestation occurred over a longer period as a result of climate change, and rats probably also played a part. The islanders did not go through a population collapse until after the arrival of Europeans, they say.

Hunt has examined new data from the Hawaiian and other Pacific islands that shows that by early historic times the deforestation of Easter Island was already complete, or nearly so. A dense forest of palm trees and shrubs had mostly disappeared and as a result, as many as six land bird species had also become extinct. Crucially, much of the forest damage appears to have been done before evidence of fires on the island. However, almost all of the palm seed shells discovered on the island were found to have been gnawed by rats which would have made them unable to germinate. Evidence from other Pacific islands also confirms how destructive rats can be. However, John Flenley of New Zealand's Massey University, who carried out much of the radio-carbon work on Easter Island, says there is ample evidence for a much earlier arrival of Polynesian settlers. He refutes the arguments of the sceptics: whilst admitting that the Europeans did bring certain disasters, he maintains that Hunt and Lipo are ignoring archaeological, botanical and sedimentological evidence proving the island was transformed from a subtropical rainforest to a treeless landscape. The radio-carbon dating points to an initial colonisation before AD900, Flenley argues. This was ample time for the rapid deforestation, environmental collapse and a population crash, he insists.

Why all this is important today is not, of course, lost in the age of globalisation, climate change and a rapidly growing world population in the billions. As Diamond says: 'The parallels between Easter Island and the whole of the modern world are chillingly obvious.'

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Questions 27–30

Complete the summary using the list of words and phrases, **A–D**, *below.*

LIST OF WORDS AND PHRASES

A poverty
B agriculture
C boats
D wood

Q	Statement	Answer
27	there was no _____ around, which would have helped with their construction	
28	the poor quality of the local inhabitants' _____ made long sea journeys mysterious	
29	the people were living in _____ at the time of Roggeveen's visit	
30	there was no evidence of successful _____ on the island	

Questions 31–35

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer? Write **YES**, **NO** *or* **NOT GIVEN**.

31 Erich von Däniken's claims were briefly accepted by some sections of society.

32 Archaeologists removed valuable artefacts from the island.

33 Smallpox continued to affect Easter Island's inhabitants for centuries.

34 It remains open to question whether Easter Island was once covered in forest.

35 The way that rats arrived on Easter Island is still to be established.

Questions 36–40

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**.

36 What does Jared Diamond blame for the lack of vegetation on Easter Island?

A The construction of stone statues
B Climate change over a long period
C A method of transportation
D The arrival of Europeans

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37 What do Hunt and Lipo suggest about the population of Easter Island?

A It collapsed before European contact
B The first settlers arrived much later than is widely accepted
C It never exceeded a few thousand inhabitants
D It declined mainly because of disease

38 What is suggested about rats on Easter Island in the fifth paragraph?

A They were a likely cause of deforestation
B They arrived after the forests had disappeared
C They had no effect on plant regeneration
D They were introduced by Europeans

39 Flenley responds to Hunt and Lipo's theory by

A dismissing it
B partially supporting it
C expanding on their arguments
D avoiding direct criticism

40 The writer's purpose in this article is to

A argue in favour of Diamond's interpretation
B provide an overview of a series of arguments
C prove that rats were the main cause of deforestation
D criticise modern archaeological methods

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 3

Volume 9 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

New Understanding of Giraffes in the Wild

Even as the tallest animals on Earth, giraffes can be easy to overlook. Despite being a favorite in zoos, until recently almost nobody studied giraffes in the wild. 'When I first became interested in giraffes in 2008 and started looking through the scientific literature, I was really surprised to see how little had been done,' said Megan Strauss, an animal researcher at the University of Minnesota, USA. All that is changing fast, as a growing number of researchers seek to understand the biology and complex behavior of this graceful giant in its native habitat.

Giraffes, found throughout sub-Saharan Africa, are currently classified as a single species with up to nine varieties that differ by features like head shape and whether the fur on their legs is plain or patterned. The giraffe is not listed as endangered, but researchers point to evidence that in the past 15 years, the population has fallen some 40 percent.

Recent studies have allowed researchers new insights into giraffes' social structures. Groups of female giraffes, for example, have been found to form close friendships that can last for years. 'We're just at the beginnings of trying to understand this kind of behavior,' Dr Strauss said. Female giraffes can live 20 years or more, and it makes sense they might rely on each other for clues to the best feeding grounds, help with taking care of their young, or the reduction of stress, by staying in groups.

Mother giraffes have displayed signs of grief after losing their young, known as calves, to lions. Dr Strauss described one case in which a mother spent four days at the place where a lion had eaten her calf, refusing food, and often in the company of two other adult females. Giraffe calves are extremely vulnerable to predators, and though mothers will fight valiantly to keep their young alive - kicking forward and backward - half of all calves are killed in their first year of life.

Male giraffes, known as bulls, generally become more important with age, and older bulls display that dominance physically and behaviorally: as their neck muscles grow, the male's posture becomes prouder and more vertical. Recent observations show young bulls, when left on their own, mimicking their elders: head held high and neck puffed out. But should a dominant older bull come into view, the younger males instantly try to make themselves look small and innocent.

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The younger bulls have reason to fear their elders. Clashes have been witnessed between adults when each bull repeatedly 'necks' the other, using his massive neck to slam his head against his rival. One bull somehow survived with a broken neck.

Physical features of giraffes: study findings

The skin of a giraffe is mostly gray. The coat has dark patches separated by light hair, which serves as camouflage, allowing them to blend in with the light and shade patterns of the acacia trees from which they feed. Grazing giraffes are hard to see even a few meters away.

Research indicates that giraffes also have excellent sight, can see in color and over great distances, which helps them to spot lions and keep track of each other. In addition, a giraffe's extraordinary mouth has lips and tongue that can together grasp a branch and then pluck away the leaves while avoiding thorns, almost as humans would grab with their hands. Each day, a giraffe consumes about 30 kilograms of leaves, shoots and vines, all digested in its four-chambered stomach.

A giraffe can stand more than six meters tall, with its neck accounting for roughly a third of its height and its legs the same. The giraffe's long neck is due to the length of the vertebrae, not the number of vertebrae. The growth of the neck largely takes place during early childhood, as giraffe mothers would have a difficult time giving birth to young with longer necks. The giraffe's head and neck are held up by large muscles attached to the lower spine.

Recent studies show that the greatest challenge to the giraffe's cardiovascular system is how to both pump blood very high and retrieve it from far below. The outside of a giraffe's veins are extremely thick, to prevent blood leaking into surrounding tissue. Other adaptations in the cardiovascular system allow the giraffe to bend over for a drink of water, and then raise its head again quickly without fainting.

Researchers were also surprised to find that a giraffe does not have an unusually large heart. It is half a percent of body mass, the same as in a mouse. Moreover, the amount of blood pumped into circulation is modest, proportionally lower than it is in humans. That could help explain why giraffes rarely run for very long: enough oxygen cannot be delivered to their muscles fast enough for them to keep running. Or maybe the giraffes are worried about tripping over their own feet. This is because signals from the nerves travel at about the same speed in giraffes as in rats or other mammals. Given the greater distance they have to travel in the giraffe to reach the brain, it is possible the giraffe faces real challenges in reacting quickly to a rock beneath its hoof or a bite to its ankle.

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New understanding of this wonderful animal sheds light on both its physiology and its behavior. Researchers hope to use this knowledge to increase their ability to work with preservation, as its habitat is reduced and the giraffe becomes scarcer.

Questions 1–7

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage? Write **TRUE**, **FALSE** *or* **NOT GIVEN**.

1. The amount of research on giraffes in their natural environment has increased lately.
2. Megan Strauss disapproves of keeping giraffes in zoos.
3. The number of giraffes in Africa has nearly doubled.
4. Female giraffes tend to live longer than males.
5. Mother giraffes sometimes use their legs to defend their young.
6. Younger bulls hold their necks higher in the presence of more powerful males.
7. Male giraffes have been observed fighting.

Questions 8–13

Complete the table below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Physical feature	Study finding
Skin / Coat	Provides (8) ~~when~~ standing near trees
Eyes	Let them look out for lions
Mouth	Can be used like (9) ~~to get~~ leaves
Neck	About equal in length to the legs; length develops in childhood to provide an easier (10) ~~for m~~others
Cardiovascular system	Extra-strong (11) ~~keep~~ blood from spilling into other tissue
	(12) ~~norm~~al size for such a large animal
Nerves	Slower reaction time because (13) ~~need~~ to go farther to the brain

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Reading Passage 2

Healthy Buildings, Productive People

A Have you felt tired at your desk lately? According to new research, some often overlooked environmental factors within buildings - the degree or type of ventilation, airborne contaminants, lighting and noise levels, for example - can play a surprisingly large role in how good or bad you feel, and even how well you think. It is estimated that we spend more than 90 percent of our time inside, but builders in general have paid little attention to the health aspects of indoor spaces, instead focusing on superficial design features and on meeting minimum environmental standards to keep costs down.

B Researchers at Harvard University in the US looked at the effects of indoor air quality on workers' cognitive performance - important both for health and for companies' bottom lines, says Joseph Allen, assistant professor of environmental health and principal investigator of the studies. 'The true cost of running our buildings should take into account the health and productivity of people in those buildings,' Allen says. In fact, an analysis by the team showed that the cost of making alterations that could boost cognitive performance significantly was minuscule compared with the related increase in productivity - about $40 per person, per year, compared with a $6,500 increase in employee productivity.

C The team's first study, published in Environmental Health Perspectives, was conducted at the Syracuse Center of Excellence, a US research organization devoted to studying and developing sustainability. The center houses a laboratory that allows researchers to test a wide range of indoor air quality factors using sophisticated ventilation. Each day, the indoor environment was controlled with a ventilation system which included small amounts of carbon dioxide and volatile organic compounds, or VOCs - the toxic by-products of office supplies commonly found in the workplace. The office workers were blinded to the conditions. For six days over two weeks, 24 office workers with administrative, technical, professional or managerial jobs came to the lab and performed their regular work under minimal supervision, as well as participating in an hour and a half of cognitive testing at the end of the day. The cognitive tasks used in the study had participants respond to online scenarios that mimic real-life situations, such as running a city as a mayor. The findings are remarkable for showing in a well-controlled study, that indoor air quality can significantly lower cognitive performance in buildings that would otherwise meet current building standards, notes environmental psychologist Craig Zimring, director of Georgia Tech University's SimTigrate Design Lab in the US. 'If these findings are replicated in other labs and in real-world work environments,' he says, 'they could lead to designs that provide much more outside air through mechanical ventilation or operable windows, for example' - in turn, promoting better health and performance.

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D In a second study, reported in Building and Environment, the Harvard-Syracuse team moved from the lab to the real world. Using the same methodology, they compared test scores of 109 people working in 10 buildings - about 12 people per site - in two buildings in each of five cities. When the team examined the buildings for differences, they found that certified buildings had lower humidity levels and brighter light than the non-certified buildings. That said, the differences in humidity and lighting didn't entirely explain the differing cognitive function scores of people on the job. This has led researchers to believe that other factors, such as how someone feels about their working environment, may also play a part, notes Harvard research fellow Piers MacNaughton, who led the study.

E A recently constructed building on the Washington University campus in St. Louis, US, is providing another opportunity to examine how green building design can affect health and behavior. Hillman Hall was designed with the highest environmental and energy standards available, as well as design elements intended to foster more collaboration and physical activity, says Amy Eyler, associate professor and assistant dean for public health at the Brown School at Washington University. The design includes easy access to stairways, plenty of natural light, generous spaces for collaboration, desks that allow people to sit or stand up, and inviting places to walk. Unlike traditional hallways designed as long corridors with private offices to either side, for example, these hallways include classrooms, offices and spaces to sit, so they are multi-use - 'you have many reasons to walk them,' says Eyler. To test how the building might affect people's behavior, Eyler conducted a pre-test before people moved in, and a post-test one year later. Her team collected data on the three main features the designers were attempting to foster: physical activity, collaboration and sustainable practices. Results showed that people were more likely to take part in spontaneous collaborations in the new space than in the older ones, and to be physically active.

F Like other researchers in this growing field, Eyler sees multidisciplinary collaboration as the key to success. Administrators, public health faculty and architects worked together to create a building that captured the university's vision for a space that fosters collegial work and health for faculty, staff and students - a shared goal evidenced by the fact that the architecture firm that designed the building also funded part of the research. 'Complex projects like this one need teams of people with varied backgrounds and expertise in order to solve them,' Eyler says.

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Questions 14–19

Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.

LIST OF HEADINGS

i The effects of a new environmentally friendly building on the people who work there

ii The ability of well-designed workplaces to attract the best staff

iii The assessment of workplaces in several locations

iv The low priority given to making buildings healthy for users

v Achieving design efficiency by involving a range of specialists

vi Workers were assessed outside of their usual workplace

vii Workplace changes based on worker feedback

viii The financial benefits of efficient workplaces

Q	Paragraph	Answer
14	Paragraph A	
15	Paragraph B	
16	Paragraph C	
17	Paragraph D	
18	Paragraph E	
19	Paragraph F	

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Questions 20–23

Match each statement with the correct researcher, **A–D**. *NB You may use any letter more than once.*

LIST OF RESEARCHERS

A Joseph Allen
B Craig Zimring
C Piers MacNaughton
D Amy Eyler

Q	Statement	Answer
20	Further investigations will result in improved wellbeing and efficiency.	
21	A person's opinion of their workspace may influence how well they perform at work.	
22	The design of a workplace can have an impact on how much staff work with their colleagues.	
23	A worker's mental capacity may be considerably reduced due to their working environment.	

Questions 24–26

Complete the summary below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Allen's first study was done at the Syracuse Center, which focuses on researching (24) ————————. In this study, a complex ventilation system was used to control the airflow in the simulated workplace. All staff carried out normal duties during the day without much (25) ————————. Later in the day participants were assessed as they performed tasks which required them to play a role, for example acting as (26) ———————— while dealing with practical problems.

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Reading Passage 3

Child's Play in Medieval England

Professor Nicholas Orme investigates childhood in the Middle Ages

A 'Play up! Play up! And play the game!' The ringing chorus of Sir Henry Newbolt's celebrated cricket poem Vitai Lampada (1908) sums up views about play in 19th- and early 20th-century Britain. Children's play was important, and adults should regulate and direct it. Games promoted endurance, self-discipline and team spirit - qualities needed for the health of society and government. Newbolt was one in a long line of people who thought in this way. The notion that children's play should be used for educational and social purposes goes back at least to the ancient Greeks and the toys and games of medieval England tell us much about how adults then saw childhood. But they also reveal a good deal about children themselves, and cast light on what has recently become a controversial issue.

B Forty years ago, the French historian Philippe Aries argued, in Centuries of Childhood, that childhood in the Middle Ages did not exist in its modern sense. Children were regarded by adults with relatively little affection and followed a way of life not very different from that of their elders. More recent historians have disputed this, pointing to plentiful signs of parental affection and arguing that childhood, by its very nature, must always have been much the same.

C In this debate play is crucial. Did adults encourage it? If so, did they see it as recreational (by providing toys, for example) or as educational (making children play in particular ways)? Did children play as their elders told them, or did they invent their own games, away from adults and even against their wishes? These questions can be answered from a rich body of evidence including actual toys of the period, pictures of children's activities in contemporary manuscripts and literary sources such as religious works and dictionaries. We know not only how medieval English children played but what their elders thought on the subject.

D We know, for example, that adults gave children toys from infancy onwards. In 1398 the writer John Trevisa describes babies playing with 'a child's brooch', an object similar in function to the bright plastic toys given to babies today to bite and handle. William Horman, 16th-century author of a Latin textbook, talks of buying a rattle to stop a baby crying. Indeed, by 1300 it appears there was a toy industry in England. Boys' toys often took military forms, such as the two metal soldiers of that date, found in London, and made from a mould. Girls had dolls, known before the 17th century as 'poppets' or puppets, commercially manufactured, imported and, in 1582, taxed at a halfpenny each. Not that

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children were by any means dependent on things that were bought for them. Gerald of Wales recalls how he and his brothers built towns, palaces, churches and monasteries from sand at Manorbier Castle in about 1150 (perhaps on the nearby beach).

E Active games were universal. In his English-to-Latin dictionary of 1440, a mysterious recluse known as Geoffrey mentions children playing 'tennis' and swinging on what he calls a 'totter' or 'merrytotter'. Children chased each other, swam and played ball games. Boys in the later Middle Ages shot arrows with bows and archery is an example of a sport encouraged by adults, who wanted boys to grow up to play their part in what was, for most men, a warrior society.

F However, by no means all children's military activity was directed by adults. In 1400, six months after King Richard II had been overthrown by Henry IV, the children of London gathered together and chose themselves kings. Adam of Usk tells us they congregated 'in thousands ... and made war upon each other ... whereby many died'. The new king had to order their parents and masters to stop them.

G This willingness of children to take the initiative in play, not just to wait for adults to direct them, is evident in the way they observed the calendar. Medieval life was regulated by light, weather, crops and the Church's cycle of fasts and festivals. Children shared in the adult round of religious festivals, but had their own observances as well, semi-detached from their elders. In the 1200s, the priest Thomas Docking remarked that in spring a child 'follows the ploughman; in autumn he accompanies the grape-gatherers'. In 1518, the poet Alexander Barclay records children playing with tops in March, looking for fruit in summer and making footballs by filling pigs' bladders with dried peas in autumn.

H It is clear from this evidence that the relationship between adults and children in medieval society was, in major respects, a modern one. Parents took an indulgent interest in their children, providing them with toys and giving them time to play. Children played in a wide variety of ways - imaginatively, skilfully, athletically and violently - developing their minds, bodies and social skills. Adults tried at times to direct play - partly to keep children in order, partly to give them skills for adult life - but children gravitated to one another and formed a culture of their own. We can answer Aries's thesis, then, with a resounding 'No!'. Childhood has always been much the same.

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Questions 27–31

Which paragraph, **A–H**, *contains the following information? NB You may use any letter more than once.*

Q	Statement	Answer
27	economic evidence for play in medieval England	
28	an example of how children created their own toys	
29	an example of warlike play approved by grown-ups	
30	a political event mirrored in children's play	
31	the origin of an academic debate about medieval life	

Questions 32–35

Match each date with the correct event, **A–J**.

LIST OF EVENTS

A invention of cricket
B children picking grapes
C poem about value of games
D early toy manufacturing in England
E puppets first imported into England
F dolls taxed in England
G death of Adam of Usk
H children playing tennis
I children's gang warfare
J a description of seasonal activities

Q	Date	Answer
32	1400	
33	1518	
34	1582	
35	1908	

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Questions 36–40

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer? Write **YES**, **NO** *or* **NOT GIVEN**.

36 Little is known about adult attitudes to children's play in the Middle Ages.

37 Most toys were imported into England before 1300.

38 Medieval children celebrated the seasons in their own ways.

39 Medieval children made presents for their parents on special occasions.

40 Parents and children in the Middle Ages behaved much as they do today.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 4

Volume 9 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Traditional Farming in Zambia's Luapula Province

By tradition, land in Luapula Province is not owned by individuals but, as in many other parts of Africa, is allocated by the headman or headwoman of a village to people of either sex according to need. Since land is generally prepared by hand, a single family group cannot take on a very large area, so land has not been a limiting resource over large parts of the province. However, that situation has already changed near the main towns, and there has long been a scarcity of land for cultivation in the river valley. In both these areas, registered ownership patterns are becoming prevalent.

Most of the traditional cropping in Luapula Province is based on citemene, a system whereby crops are grown on the ashes of tree branches. As a rule, entire trees are pollarded (pollarding: removing the tops of tree branches) rather than felled, so that they can regenerate. Branches are cut over an area of land of varying size early in the dry season and then stacked to dry out. The wood is fired before the onset of the rains, and in the first year, the area is planted with the African cereal called finger millet. The grain of this crop is used to brew local drinks such as cipumu, which contributes several vitamins of the B complex to people's diets. Cipumu is also used in cementing reciprocal working relationships (Pottier 1985).

During the second year, and possibly for a few years more, the area is planted with various combinations of annuals such as maize, pumpkins, sweet potatoes, groundnuts, beans, and various leafy vegetables, grown with a certain amount of rotation. The diverse sequence ends with the vegetable cassava, which is often planted next to the last but one crop before this is harvested.

Richards (1969) observed that the practice of citemene entails a definite division of labour; men and women perform different tasks. The men stake out plots in an unobtrusive manner, since it is considered provocative towards one's neighbours to mark boundaries in an explicit way. The dangerous work of felling branches is also the men's province. Branches are then stacked by women and fired by men. Women and men cooperate in the planting work, but the harvesting is always done by women.

At the beginning of the citemene cycle, little weeding is necessary, since the firing of the branches effectively destroys weeds, but as the cycle progresses, weeds increase, and nutrients eventually become depleted to a point where further effort with annual crops is

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not worthwhile. At this point, cassava is planted, since it can produce a crop on soil that is almost exhausted. Thereafter, the plot is abandoned, and a new area is pollarded for the next cycle.

When forest is not available, a situation which is increasingly the case nowadays, a series of ridges is built, in which combinations of maize, beans, groundnuts and sweet potatoes are then planted, usually followed by cassava. These plots are normally tended by women, and provide subsistence.

Where their roots have year-round access to water, mango, guava and oil-palm trees are often grown around houses, forming a traditional agro-forestry system, and some of the fruit from these is sold by the roadside or in local markets. In addition, local varieties of rice are sometimes planted in waterlogged ground during the rainy season.

Fishing has always been a far more remunerative activity in Luapula than crop husbandry. It provides a much needed protein supplement to the diet, as well as being the one substantial source of cash. Much fish is dried for sale to areas away from the main waterways. The Mweru and Bangweulu Lake Basins are the main areas of year-round fishing, but the Luapula River is also exploited during the latter part of the dry season. Several previously abundant and desirable species have all but disappeared from Lake Mweru, apparently due to overfishing (Huckaby 1979).

Regarding animal husbandry, only small numbers of cattle or oxen are kept in the province owing to the prevalence of the tsetse fly. The resulting absence of animal power for pulling machinery greatly limits people's ability to plough and cultivate land: a married couple can rarely manage to prepare an area of more than half a hectare by hand-hoeing. However, most people keep freely roaming chickens and goats. These act as a reserve for bartering, but may also be occasionally slaughtered for ceremonies, or for entertaining important visitors. These animals are not a standard part of most people's diet.

Until recently, citemene has been an ingenious system for providing seasonal, high-quality cereals and vegetables in regions of acidic, heavily leached soils. Nutritionally, the most serious deficiency has been that of protein. However, this could be alleviated when fish were available, provided that cultivators lived near the valley or could find a source of dried fish. The citemene/fishing system was well adapted to the ecology of the woodland regions and sustainable for long periods, but only as long as human population densities stayed at low levels.

Although population densities are still much lower today than in many other parts of the world, neither the fisheries nor the woodlands of Luapula are capable, with unmodified traditional practices, of supporting the expanding population in a sustainable manner. For

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instance, even in a normal season, diets suffer from a lack of energy, protein, vitamins, and minerals. It will therefore be necessary in the future to intensify and diversify productive systems.

Questions 1–5

Complete the sentences below. Write **NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

In Luapula Province, land has traditionally been given to people on the basis of
(1) _____

The citemene system involves planting crops in the (2) _____ of wood.

In the citemene system, (3) _____ is the last crop to be planted.

In areas without trees, crops are planted in a (4) _____

If conditions are right, fruit trees may be planted near (5) _____

Questions 6–9

Match each statement with the correct animal, **A–C**. *NB You may use any letter more than once.*

LIST OF ANIMALS

A Fish
B Goats
C Oxen

Q	Statement	Answer
6	They yield the biggest profits for farmers.	
7	They may be consumed on special occasions.	
8	Because of insect pests, they do not thrive.	
9	They are often preserved and sold outside the local area.	

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Questions 10–12

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage? Write **TRUE**, **FALSE** *or* **NOT GIVEN**.

10 Agricultural land is usually prepared without the help of oxen.

11 Children are a source of extra labour during busy periods.

12 The people of Luapula Province eat chicken on a regular basis.

Question 13

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**.

13 What is the writer's opinion about traditional farming methods in Luapula Province?

A They meet all the dietary needs of the local population.

B The region's natural resources have not been fully exploited.

C They will be inadequate to support a growing population.

D A larger labour force will be required for maximum efficiency.

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Reading Passage 2

Babies Cry in Their Mother Tongue

A newborn baby's cry may sound the same to the ears of sleep-deprived parents the world over but, say scientists, comparisons of babies a few days old show that the cry of a newborn shares similarities with the language its parents speak. The reason for this is presumably the different intonation patterns in their native languages, which are already perceived in the uterus and are later reproduced.

A It is already known that human foetuses become attentive listeners in the final trimester of pregnancy. "The mother's voice in particular is sensed early on," explains Professor Amelia Finlayson of the Institute for Human Cognitive and Brain Sciences in Leipzig. "Human foetuses perceive information filtered at around 400 hertz, but they cannot hear the actual words. It is a bit like holding your head under water when someone is talking next to the bath."

B Finlayson's research indicates that newborn babies probably cannot distinguish between the accents of Welsh and Northern Scottish people or between Low German and Upper Bavarian, but they can recognise major differences in the intonation patterns of their respective mother tongues. The Leipzig researchers showed that in an earlier experiment, by means of physiological studies of babies of three to four months of age. For that study, the babies had hoods with electrodes put on their heads, and had recordings of different intonation patterns played to them. The children's brainwaves reacted to the differences even when they were asleep.

C At the same time, Doctor Katya Williams of the University of Würzburg first suggested in her PhD thesis that babies' crying might be a stage in their linguistic development. Said Williams: "It used to be thought that a baby's cry was just a signal of alarm to call its mother. This assumption was corrected when we noticed that the cries are not the same from week to week. What biological purpose would that have? If a fire siren sounded different every day, we would not even recognise it!"

D The question thus presented itself as to whether babies' cries already showed the intonation patterns of their different mother tongues. To study this, the Leipzig brain researchers and the 'screaming researchers' of the University of Würzburg worked in collaboration with their colleagues at the Laboratory of Cognitive Sciences and Linguistics, at the École Normale Supérieure in Paris, to devise a new experiment. German and French babies were selected for the comparison because the differences in the intonation shapes of these two mother tongues are particularly pronounced. For example, the German word Papa is stressed on the first syllable, while in French it is stressed on the second.

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E These three research groups made a comparison of recordings of 60 healthy newborns aged between two and five days old: 30 infants born into French-speaking families and 30 born into German-speaking families. Whenever the babies were hungry or thirsty or simply wanted their mothers and announced the fact by crying, the researchers were at the ready with their microphones and recorded their complaints. More than 20 hours of recordings of babies' crying were then fed into a computer for the purpose of analysis.

F The amazing result, published in the journal Modern Biology, is that just a few days after birth, babies use the acoustic input they perceive in the uterus to adapt their linguistic production to their target mother tongue. The melody of the German babies' screams usually began loudly and at a high pitch and then followed a downward curve, while the French babies more often screamed with a rising melody contour. Thus, they reproduce precisely the intonation patterns that are characteristic of their respective mother tongues. This proves, says the team of researchers, that babies' cries are attempts to communicate specifically with their mothers. "Newborns are probably highly motivated to imitate their mother's behaviour in order to attract her and foster bonding and therefore physical nourishment," they wrote. "Because melody contour may be the only aspect of their mother's speech that newborns are able to imitate, this might explain why we found melody contour imitation at that early age." This finding is interesting because it suggests that babies are producing sounds they have heard in the womb, meaning that this is learning rather than an innate behaviour.

G Furthermore, the findings are consistent with the hypothesis that linguistic development does not just begin from the age of nine to ten months, with the first babbling resembling language such as 'mam-mam-mam' or 'ba-ba-ba', but with the very first sounds that babies produce. "We are born to learn language. And that starts right away," says Dr Katya Williams. Dr Williams' colleague, Mr Walter Meade, discovered that this initial sensitivity to the melodic features of language assists infants to subsequently learn their mother tongue. "The melodic patterns practised in crying are building blocks for eventual sound production, such as gurgling and babbling, right up to the first words and sentences," says Meade.

H The results also demonstrated once again how language distinguishes human infants from all other primates. According to Williams, among baby chimpanzees, the 'crying melody' is closely associated with the build-up and reduction of pressure in the lungs, and is not generated by a mental process. "In comparison with the sounds of other primates, the cries of a newborn human baby display a fantastic repertoire of melodic and rhythmic variations," she adds. "Our babies are expert vocalists in comparison with all the other animals. Could that offer some small consolation for nerve-wracked parents?"

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Questions 14–19

Which paragraph contains the following information? NB You may use any letter more than once.

Q	Statement	Answer
14	a description of the methodology of an experiment carried out by several research institutes	
15	the rationale for choosing the participants of an experiment	
16	a suggestion that babies are driven to copy their mothers to gain food	
17	an account of the methodology of a past experiment carried out by the Leipzig researchers	
18	an illustration of the limitation of babies' ability to hear inside the womb	
19	an assertion that babies of different nationalities cry with different intonation	

Questions 20–23

Match each statement with the correct researcher, **A–C**. *NB You may use any letter more than once.*

LIST OF RESEARCHERS

A Professor Amelia Finlayson

B Doctor Katya Williams

C Mr Walter Meade

Q	Statement	Answer
20	Important everyday sounds must remain consistent in order to be understood.	
21	The different tones used in crying help babies to learn language later on.	
22	The tune of young primates' cries is created by their breathing, not their brain.	
23	Unborn babies in the womb are focused on the voice of one specific person.	

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Questions 24–26

Complete the sentences below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Professor Amelia Finlayson doubts unborn babies can recognise different
(24) _____

In the first Leipzig experiment, the (25) _____ of babies changed upon hearing different intonation patterns.

Early scientists believed that babies cried for no other reason than as a (26) _____ that they wanted their parents.

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Reading Passage 3

Ancient Rome: Archaeologists Are Trying to Understand More About the Early History of the City

From ancient times to the present, historians have asked the question: How and why did an ordinary little town in central Italy grow so much bigger than any other in the ancient Mediterranean and come to control such a huge empire? During the first century BCE, Roman writers themselves began systematically to study the earlier centuries of their city and their empire. Yet these historians had little more direct evidence of the earliest phases of Rome's history than modern writers have, and in some ways perhaps not as much, as there were no surviving documents or archives. Their 'histories' about the foundation of ancient Rome tell us a good deal about how the Romans saw their city, their values, and their failings. However, they tell us very little indeed about what they claim to inform us about: that is, what earliest Rome was actually like. One fact is obvious. Rome was already a very old city by 63 BCE, the birth date of its first emperor. But how exactly are we to access reliable information about the origins of Rome?

One way of doing this is by turning away from the histories of Roman writers and seeking out clues in the Latin language, or in later Roman institutions that might point back to features of earliest Rome. Much more tangible, however, is the evidence of archaeology. Dig down deep in the city of Rome, below the visible ancient monuments, and a few traces of a much earlier settlement or settlements remain. Beneath the Forum itself (an ancient marketplace at the centre of the city) lie the remains of an early cemetery, which caused tremendous excitement when they were first unearthed at the start of the 20th century. Cemeteries imply the existence of a community, and traces of that are presumably to be found in the groups of huts whose faint outlines have been detected under various parts of the later city, including on the Palatine (the centremost of the seven hills on which Rome is built). We have little idea of the nature of these huts beyond their construction in wood, clay, and thatch, and still less of the lifestyle they supported. But we can fill in some of the gaps if we look just outside Rome. One of the best preserved and most carefully excavated of these early structures was found at Fidenae, a few miles north of the city, in the 1980s. It is a rectangular building, some six by five metres, made of wood and rammed earth - a construction method still utilised up to the present day - with a simple porch around it, formed by the overhanging roof. Inside was a central hearth, some large pottery storage jars, and traces of predictable foodstuffs and domestic animals.

There are vivid glimpses of human and other life here; the question is, what do those glimpses add up to? The archaeological remains certainly demonstrate that there is a long and rich prehistory behind the ancient Rome we can still see, but quite how long that prehistory is is another matter.

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Part of the problem is the conditions of excavation in the city itself. The site of Rome has been so intensively built on for centuries that we find these traces of early occupation only in spots that happen not to have been disturbed. The foundations dug in the first and second centuries CE for the vast marble temples of the forum obliterated much of what then lay beneath the surface; the cellars of grand Renaissance houses cut through even more ancient remains in other parts of the city. So we have tiny snapshots, never the big picture. This is archaeology at its most difficult, and - although new fragments of evidence emerge all the time - its interpretation, and reinterpretation is almost always contested and often controversial. For example, there is an ongoing debate about whether the small pieces of wattle and daub found in excavations in the Forum in the mid-20th century indicate that there was an early hut settlement there too, or whether they were inadvertently introduced as part of the rubble used a few centuries later to provide a new raised surface for the area. It has to be said that this place, though fine for a cemetery, would have been rather damp and marshy for a village.

Precise dating is even more contentious. It cannot be stressed enough that there is no certain independent date for any of the archaeological material from earliest Rome or the area around, and that arguments still rage about the age of almost every major find. It has taken decades of work over the past century or so - using such diagnostics as the existence of wheel-made pottery (assumed to be later than handmade), the occasional presence on graves of Greek ceramics (whose dating is better, but still not perfectly understood) and careful comparison from site to site - to produce a rough chronological scheme covering the period from around 1000 to 600 BCE.

On that basis, the earliest burials in Rome would have been around 1000 BCE, and the earliest known settlements around 750-700 BCE. But even these dates are far from certain. Recent scientific methods - including radiocarbon dating, which calculates the age of any organic material - have suggested that they are all too 'young', by as much as a hundred years. The building at Fidenae, for example, was dated around the middle of the eighth century BCE according to traditional archaeological criteria, but that is pushed back to around the end of the ninth century BCE if we follow radiocarbon analysis. If anything, Rome appears to be getting older.

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Questions 27–32

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer? Write **YES**, **NO** *or* **NOT GIVEN**.

27 Historians have expressed little curiosity about the rise of the Roman Empire.

28 Accounts from the first century BCE of Rome's origins may be less reliable than 21st-century accounts.

29 Most Roman historians viewed their ancient capital in an unrealistically positive light.

30 The accounts by early Roman historians about the founding of Rome provide a full description of life at that time.

31 It is certain that the city of Rome was in existence long before 63 BCE.

32 Some people oppose archaeological excavations in Rome because they can damage the ancient monuments.

Questions 33–36

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**.

33 According to the writer, why were the archaeological remains found at Fidenae important?

A They shed some light on the way of life of ancient Romans.
B They were the first evidence of an ancient Roman settlement in the area.
C They overturned common assumptions about the diet of ancient Romans.
D They showed how sophisticated domestic Roman architecture could be.

34 What did Rome's marble temples and Renaissance houses have in common?

A They were the most enduring buildings of their respective eras.
B They were evidence of Rome's enormous wealth.
C They were built on previously unoccupied sites.
D Their construction destroyed evidence of earlier buildings.

35 What does the writer say in the fifth paragraph about the dating of excavated remains?

A Only the age of a proportion of remains can be agreed upon.
B Only an approximate sequence of eras can be established.
C Serious attempts at dating began only a few decades ago.
D More thorough investigations will result in reliable dates.

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36 In the final paragraph, the writer makes the point that

A traditional archaeological methods of dating have been discredited.

B many archaeologists are reluctant to abandon traditional methods of dating.

C radiocarbon dating is more accurate than archaeological methods.

D the findings of traditional archaeology and radiocarbon dating differ.

Questions 37–40

Complete each sentence with the correct ending, **A–F**, *below.*

ENDINGS

A composed of organic materials which are in use in the 21st century.

B referred to in popular legends about the origins of Rome.

C constructed on the site of an earlier burial ground.

D used to determine the relative dates of various Roman artefacts.

E chosen as the area for the greatest number of archaeological excavations.

F expected to shed some light on what Rome was originally like.

Q	Sentence start	Answer
37	The Latin language can be	
38	The Roman Forum was	
39	The recently discovered building at Fidenae was	
40	Ancient Greek pottery is sometimes	

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 5

Volume 9 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

The Origins of Tennis

The game of tennis has a very long history. It is officially still known as "lawn tennis," partly because it was originally only played on grass, and also to distinguish it from the older game known as "real tennis," from which the modern game developed.

Some people believe that the ancient Egyptians, Greeks, and Romans played various versions of tennis. No drawings or descriptions of any tennis-like games have been discovered, but a couple of Arabic words dating from ancient Egyptian times are cited as evidence. The theory goes that the name "tennis" is derived from the Egyptian town of Tennis alongside the Nile, and the word "racquet" evolved from the Arabic word for the palm of the hand, rahat.

Aside from these two Arabic words, there is no other evidence for any form of tennis prior to the year 1000. Most historians believe the origins of the game date back to 11th- and 12th-century France. It's thought that French monks were the first to play a basic game of handball against their monastery buildings, or over a rope strung across a courtyard. Those who dispute more ancient origins argue that the name "tennis" is derived from the French tenez, which meant something to the effect of "take this," said as one player would serve to the other.

This game took on the name jeu de paume, which means "game of the hand or palm." But as they found playing with bare hands quite uncomfortable, players began using a simple glove, and later either a glove with webbing between the fingers or a solid paddle, similar to the ones used in table tennis today. Wooden racquets were not invented until much later.

The French nobility learned the game from the monks, and some accounts report as many as 1,800 tennis courts in France by the 13th century. The game, which remained exclusive to the upper classes, gained more popularity over the 14th and 15th centuries. As it became increasingly fashionable, outdoor courtyards were modified into indoor courts. The game became such a widespread diversion among the aristocracy that both the pope and the French king tried to ban it. By the 16th century, the game had spread to England, where it became known as "tennis." Both kings Henry VII and Henry VIII were avid players who promoted the building of courts, and it also became a very fashionable game among the English upper classes.

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An example of one of these early "real tennis" courts can be seen at the royal palace of Hampton Court near London. It was built in 1525 and is still used today. Only a handful of such courts remain. It is a tall, narrow indoor court, bearing more resemblance to a squash court than the type of tennis courts we are familiar with today. "Real tennis" is a remarkably fast and difficult game as the ball can be bounced off any of the surfaces, some of which are slanted at odd angles. The net is just over 1.5 metres high at each end, but drops to just under a metre in the middle.

Until the 19th century, the ball was either constructed from a wad of hair, wool, or cork wrapped in string and cloth or leather. Then a major development took place when Charles Goodyear invented vulcanisation, a process that allows rubber to withstand heat and cold. This led to the development of rubber tennis balls. During the 1850s, players began to experiment with these new balls, which bounced easily on outdoor grass courts.

In 1874 a Welshman, Major Walter C. Wingfield, known as "the father of lawn tennis," had the idea of devising rules, which he published. He also introduced standardised equipment, including racquets, balls, posts, and a net, which he patented and sold in sets. The game quickly became a very popular and sociable open-air pursuit for the English middle classes. People also started playing tennis in countries such as the United States, Russia, India, Canada, and China. However, not all of Wingfield's ideas ultimately survived. Inspired by his knowledge of Greek, he called his version of tennis Sphairistike - a name which never caught on. Interestingly, his original court had the shape of an hourglass, with the net across its narrowest section.

A major tennis tournament took place for the first time in Wimbledon, London in 1877, and its organising committee came up with a rectangular court and a modified set of rules that are essentially the same as for the game we know today. The net was still high at the sides, a carryover from the game's indoor ancestor. But by 1882, the specifications for the size of the court, the equipment, and the rules had evolved to their current form.

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Questions 1–6

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage? Write **TRUE**, **FALSE** *or* **NOT GIVEN**.

1 There are a few surviving documents which show that a game similar to tennis was played in the ancient world.

2 An early form of tennis involved players hitting a ball with just their hand.

3 The game of table tennis developed around the same time as tennis.

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4 Tennis became popular with all sections of French society in the 14th and 15th centuries.

5 The indoor courts created in the 14th and 15th centuries were larger than the outdoor courtyards.

6 There were attempts to prevent French aristocrats from playing tennis.

Questions 7–13

Complete the notes below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

The Development of Tennis in England

"REAL TENNIS" COURT AT HAMPTON COURT

- The ball may be hit against the 7 ——— around the court
- The 8 ——— is lower in the centre

1850S

- Balls made out of 9 ——— started to be used

1874

- Major Walter C. Wingfield published written 10 ——— for the game
- Produced complete sets of tennis 11 ——— for sale
- Introduced a name for the game which was never adopted
- Designed an unusual 12 ——— for the court

1877

- The first large 13 ——— was held

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Reading Passage 2

John Ray and the Study of Plants

A The 17th-century English scholar and botanist John Ray was well aware that he lived through, and participated in, a profound revolution in the way people interacted with nature. In the preface to his Synopsis of British Plants, published in 1690, he gave thanks that he had been born at a time when traditional dependence on the teaching of the Greek philosopher Aristotle (384-322 BCE) had given way to a new philosophy, based on experiment and observation of the real world, that we now call science.

B Ray was born in 1627. His father was a village blacksmith, and his mother was also a respected member of the community, a healer who was an expert in folk medicine and the use of herbs to treat ailments. Ray must have stood out as an unusually bright boy among his schoolmates, and his talents were recognised by a church official, Samuel Covell, who had graduated from Cambridge University in 1600, and maintained his links with his university. Through his influence, Ray was admitted to Cambridge University in 1644 at the age of seventeen - a huge step for a village blacksmith's son. There he made a solid start, and quickly gained a reputation as a brilliant student. He studied the classics (Greek, Latin and Hebrew) and mathematics, but there was nothing yet we would now call science in the curriculum. After graduating in 1648, he became a minor member of staff at Trinity College, Cambridge. He was appointed Lecturer in Greek in 1651, Lecturer in Mathematics in 1653, and Lecturer in Humanities in 1655.

C Almost immediately after graduating, Ray also seems to have developed the interest to which he would devote the rest of his life: the study of the natural world. He explains this conversion into a naturalist - in particular into a botanist - in the preface to his first book, the Cambridge Catalogue of English Plants. Here Ray tells us that he suffered an illness in his early twenties, and was advised to take long walks and ride in the fresh air while recovering. While doing this, he became interested in the local flora, and finding nobody able to teach him, Ray investigated it for himself. He then went on to pass on the knowledge he acquired to others.

D By the mid-1650s, even the first-year students at Trinity College were able to identify the plants and flowers around Cambridge, as they were being taught (unofficially - none of this was part of their formal education) by Ray. Many of them were the sons of landowners, and so had a natural, if amateurish, interest in country matters. But a few of them took his efforts to understand the natural world much more seriously. One of these, Francis Willughby, later played an important part in Ray's life.

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E Having himself had no authority on the subject of plants on which to draw, Ray also started work on what would become his Cambridge Catalogue of English Plants. The work was not published until 1660 because, as Ray explained in the preface, he had to start from scratch: "I had first to become familiar with the literature, to compare the plants that I found with the pictures, and when there seemed to be a resemblance, to go fully into any unknown descriptions. Gaining skill by experience, I acquired at last the ability to recognise to what tribe and family similars could be assigned; this taught me to search for similarities and saved a vast deal of labour, which others would have spent in their difficulties. I was eager to make the most of this and was fortunate to share my enthusiasm with my friends ..."

F Ray's Cambridge Catalogue of English Plants was much more than a simple list of species. It gave the names of plants found in the area around Cambridge and included information about where they grew and how common they were. In doing this, Ray was producing something that would be of practical use to students and other readers interested in the local natural world. At the same time, the book showed his determination to describe plants accurately, on the basis of direct examination rather than reliance on old authorities. In this respect, it reflected the spirit of the new learning that Ray admired.

G Ray's studies of plants were only the beginning of a much larger ambition. With the support of Francis Willughby, he began to imagine a more comprehensive investigation of nature, one that would attempt to classify living things according to careful observation of their shared characteristics. This was an ambitious undertaking, especially at a time when many aspects of the natural world remained poorly described. Yet Ray believed that by collecting evidence systematically and comparing related forms, it would be possible to build a more reliable understanding of nature than scholars had possessed before.

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Questions 14–20

Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.

LIST OF HEADINGS

i Ray's account of his working methods
ii The botanical expert who inspired Ray
iii A succession of academic achievements
iv Ray's informal tuition
v Ray's appreciation of his contemporary academic culture
vi A childhood interest in plants
vii Plans for a bold new project
viii A description of the content of Ray's first book
ix A change of direction for Ray

Q	Paragraph	Answer
14	Paragraph A	
15	Paragraph B	
16	Paragraph C	
17	Paragraph D	
18	Paragraph E	
19	Paragraph F	
20	Paragraph G	

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Questions 21–24

Complete the summary below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

A New Approach to Knowledge

John Ray was a scholar and self-taught botanist, whose work reflected the (21) _____ that was taking place during the 17th century in people's way of thinking about the natural world. This new approach is the basis of the modern field of (22) _____. It represented a complete break from the ideas of Aristotle, which had dominated thinking up until that time. As Ray himself explained, his interest in plants was aroused after graduating, when he had to spend time outdoors after a period of (23) _____. He taught himself, in addition to many Cambridge (24) _____, and began compiling his catalogue of plants, which was published in 1660.

Questions 25 and 26

Choose **TWO** *letters, A–E. Which* **TWO** *of the following statements are true of Ray's early life?*

A His teacher recommended that he should go to university.
B His school record was not exceptional in any way.
C He was helped by a former student of Cambridge University.
D His parents were both valued by the people in their local area.
E He originally planned to take up his father's occupation.

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Reading Passage 3

Sir Francis Ronalds 1788–1873

An early pioneer in the story of long-distance communication

A Francis Ronalds was born in London in 1788, the second of eleven children. When he was nineteen his father died, and as the eldest son, the young Ronalds had to assume the responsibility of running the family's cheese business. He combined this occupation with his passions for chemical experiments and for meteorology, the study of the Earth's atmosphere and its changes. This brought him into contact with the elderly Swiss meteorologist Jean Andre de Luc, who was also an inspired inventor in the field of electricity. In 1814, de Luc encouraged Ronalds to start work on this new discipline.

B For the next few years, Ronalds experimented enthusiastically with various kinds of electrostatic clockwork devices. He was particularly interested in the idea of electric telegraphy: transmitting messages over distance, using electrical impulses carried along metal wires. In the best traditions of nineteenth-century scientists, these investigations were carried out at home. In early 1816, Ronalds gutted the family home in Hammersmith, West London, and covered its rooms, halls, and staircases with electric wire. This experiment involved the use of current to produce movement in small corks at the ends of circuits.

C Some months later, Ronalds built two large wooden frames accommodating 8 miles (12.9 km) of electrically charged iron wire in his back garden. At either end of the wire was a revolving disc, on which letters and numbers were engraved. These dials were kept revolving by means of a clockwork mechanism. When somebody wanted to send a message, he would wait until the dial at his end was showing the desired number or letter, and then interrupt the charge on the wire. This would cause two balls suspended on the wire to fall together. The person at the opposite end would then note down what was indicated by the dial at his end at the moment when the balls made contact. Ronalds soon developed a modified version of his invention in which the wire was encased in glass tubes and buried in the ground. The system was slow and depended on the two dials staying in step, but it worked.

D Ronalds immediately contacted the Admiralty, the department of the British government which had control over the nation's naval affairs. He was not the first to propose a system of this nature to them. Some ten years earlier, in 1806, the inventor Ralph Wedgwood had offered the Admiralty a similar type of telegraph based on frictional electricity, which it had rejected. The Admiralty had its home in London, whereas its naval

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fleets were based over 130 km away in Portsmouth. With communication between these two cities in mind, Ronalds wrote to Lord Melville, the then First Lord of the Admiralty, to offer him his telegraphic system.

E Ronalds believed that his invention was capable of carrying messages some 800 km, and in his letter to Lord Melville written on 11 July 1816 he spoke of the "mode of conveying telegraphic intelligence with great rapidity, accuracy, and certainty, in all states of the atmosphere, either at night or in the day, and at small expense." In 1816, the Admiralty had at its disposal only the late eighteenth-century telegraphic system of semaphore, whereby a mechanical device was used to control a mast with two arms. The disadvantage of this system was that it was only usable in daylight and in clear weather conditions. Nevertheless, John Barrow, Secretary to the Admiralty, wrote back to Ronalds on 5 August, saying that "telegraphs of any kind are wholly unnecessary, and NO other than the one now in use will be adopted."

F Ronalds did not pursue the matter further or attempt to patent his telegraph. However, in a small pamphlet published in 1823, he described his invention and listed some of its potential uses. Although Ronalds lived long enough to see his prophecies come to fruition, he made no further contribution to the progress of telegraphic communication. In 1843, he was appointed the first Honorary Director and Superintendent of the Observatory at Kew, where he devised an accurate, automatic system for registering meteorological data using photography. A similar system was developed independently by Charles Brooke, but the British Association of Meteorologists confirmed Ronalds's priority. His system remained in use for many decades.

G Meanwhile, the people who benefited most directly from Ronalds's telegraphic work were the physicist Charles Wheatstone and his business partner William Cooke. They saw the potential of a rapid communication system for the growing number of private railway companies, and in 1837 they developed the Wheatstone-Cooke five-needle telegraph. The pair patented their design in the same year, the first of its kind to be officially registered, and reaped considerable financial gain as a result. Ronalds himself retired in 1852 and devoted his later years to collecting and cataloguing a vast library of published material on electricity and magnetism. In 1870, three years before he died, he was knighted by Queen Victoria, a belated honour in recognition of his "early and remarkable labours in telegraphic investigations."

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Questions 27–31

Match each event with the correct date, **A–H**.

LIST OF DATES

A 1806
B 1814
C 1816
D 1823
E 1837
F 1843
G 1852
H 1870

Q	Event	Answer
27	The first electric telegraph system was submitted to the Admiralty.	
28	Ronalds received official recognition of his contribution to telegraphy.	
29	The first electric telegraph was patented.	
30	Ronalds began to experiment with electricity.	
31	Ronalds informed the public about the possible uses of his telegraph.	

Questions 32–35

Answer the questions below. Write **NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** *from the passage for each answer.*

What was marked on the dials on Ronalds's garden telegraph? (32) _____

What did Ronalds use to enclose the wires on his later version of the garden telegraph? (33) _____

How far did Ronalds believe his telegraph could transmit information? (34) _____

What did the communication system invented by Ralph Wedgwood use? (35) _____

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Questions 36–40

Which paragraph, **A–G**, *contains the following information? NB You may use any letter more than once.*

Q	Statement	Answer
36	a description of a commercial application for the electric telegraph	
37	a rejection of Ronalds's invention	
38	a drawback of Ronalds's invention	
39	reference to the positive influence on Ronalds of a fellow scientist	
40	reference to the adoption of one of Ronalds's procedures in preference to that of another scientist	

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 6

Volume 9 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Health in the Wild

Many animals seem able to treat their illnesses themselves. Humans may have a thing or two to learn from them.

For the past decade, Dr Cindy Engel, a lecturer in Environmental Sciences at Britain's Open University, has been collating examples of self-medicating behaviour in wild animals. In a recent talk, she explained that the idea that animals can treat themselves has been generally regarded with some scepticism by other animal behaviourists. But a growing number of them now think that wild animals can and do deal with their own medical needs.

Dr William Karesh of the Wildlife Conservation Society in New York, for example, has studied the health of a wide range of wild animals, including anaconda snakes, macaws, penguins, impala and buffalo. The animals were mostly in good physical condition, which is not surprising since the weak quickly die in the wild. But blood tests showed that many had encountered unpleasant viral and bacterial diseases in the past - including diseases that are often fatal in captive animals, even when treated by vets. Moreover, if healthy wild animals are brought into captivity, their health often deteriorates unless great care is taken over their living conditions. Such observations suggest that wild animals can do something to keep themselves healthy that captive animals cannot.

One example of self-medication was discovered in 1987. Dr Michael Huffman and Mohamedi Seifu, working in the Mahale Mountains National Park in Tanzania, noticed that local chimpanzees suffering from intestinal worms would dose themselves with the pith (the white substance between the skin and the flesh) of a plant called Vernonia. This plant produces poisonous chemicals called terpenes. Its pith contains a strong enough concentration to kill gut parasites, but not so strong as to kill chimps (nor people for that matter; locals use the pith for the same purpose).

Since the Vernonia-eating chimps were discovered, more evidence has emerged suggesting that animals often eat things for medical rather than nutritional reasons. Many species, for example, consume dirt - a behaviour known as geophagy. Historically, the preferred explanation was that soil supplies minerals such as salt. But geophagy occurs in areas

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where the earth is not a useful source of minerals, and also in places where minerals can be more easily obtained from certain plants that are known to be rich in them. Clearly, the animals must be getting something else out of eating the earth.

The current belief is that soil - and particularly the clay in it - helps to detoxify the defensive poisons that some plants produce in an attempt to prevent themselves from being eaten. Evidence for the detoxifying nature of clay came in 1999 from an experiment carried out on macaws by Dr James Gilardi and his colleagues at the University of California, Davis. Macaws eat seeds containing alkaloids, a group of chemicals that has some notoriously toxic members, such as strychnine. In the wild, the birds are frequently seen perched on eroding riverbanks eating clay. Dr Gilardi fed one group of macaws a mixture of harmless alkaloid and clay, and a second group just the alkaloid. Several hours later, the macaws that had eaten the clay had 60% less alkaloid in their bloodstreams than those that had not, suggesting that the current hypothesis is correct.

A third instance of animals' self-medication is the use of mechanical scours to get rid of gut parasites. In 1972, Dr Richard Wrangham, a researcher at the Gombe Stream Reserve in Tanzania, noticed that chimpanzees were eating the leaves of a tree called Aspilia. The chimps chose the leaves carefully by testing them in their mouths. Having chosen a leaf, a chimp would fold it into a fan and swallow it. Some of the chimps were noticed wrinkling their noses as they swallowed these leaves, suggesting the experience was unpleasant. Later, undigested leaves were found on the forest floor.

Dr Wrangham rightly guessed that the leaves had a medicinal purpose - this was, indeed, one of the earliest interpretations of a behaviour pattern known as self-medication. However, he guessed wrong about what the mechanism was. His (and everybody else's) assumption was that Aspilia released a drug, and this sparked more than two decades of phytochemical research to try to find out what chemical the chimps were after. But by the 1990s, chimps across Africa had been seen swallowing the leaves of 19 different Aspilia species that seemed to have few suitable chemicals in common. The drug hypothesis was looking more and more dubious.

It was Dr Huffman who got to the root of the problem. He did so by watching what came out of the chimps, rather than concentrating on what went in. He found that the egested leaves were full of intestinal worms. The factor common to all 19 species of leaves swallowed by the chimps was that they were covered with microscopic hooks. These caught the worms and dragged them from their lodgings.

Dr Engel is now particularly excited about how knowledge of the way that animals look after themselves could be used to improve the health of livestock. People might also be able to learn a thing or two - and may, indeed, already have done so. Geophagy, for example, is

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a common behaviour in many parts of the world. The medical stalls in African markets frequently sell tablets made of different sorts of clays, appropriate to different medical conditions.

Africans brought to the Americas as slaves continued this tradition, which gave their owners one more excuse to affect to despise them. Yet, as Dr Engel points out, Rwandan mountain gorillas eat a type of clay rather similar to kaolinite - the main ingredient of many patent medicines sold over the counter in the West for digestive complaints. Dirt can sometimes be good for you, and to be 'as sick as a parrot' may, after all, be a state to be desired.

Questions 1–4

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage? Write **TRUE**, **FALSE** *or* **NOT GIVEN**.

1 Dr Engel has spent ten years gathering evidence for the notion that animals treat their own illnesses.

2 Animal behaviourists have always believed that animals know how to heal themselves.

3 Dr Karesh enlisted the help of a medical team during his research.

4 Wild animals taken into captivity tend to experience a decline in health.

Questions 5–9

Complete the table below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Researchers	Subjects	Self-treatment	Findings	Other observations
Michael Huffman & Mohamedi Seifu, 1987	Chimps with worms	Eat 5 ——— of Vernonia plant	Plant contains toxins known as 6 ——— that kill parasites.	Remedy also used by people
James Gilardi, 1999	Macaws that consume poison-bearing seeds	Eat clay	Clay leads to reduction in level of 7 ~~in blood~~	
Richard Wrangham	Chimps with gut parasites	Eat Aspilia leaves	Undigested leaves wrongly believed to contain a 8 ———	Chimps indicate leaves have an 9 ~~taste~~

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Questions 10–13

Complete the summary below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Soil as Medication

The consumption of soil for medicinal reasons is called (10) _____. Initially, people believed that animals ate dirt to get (11) _____ and other minerals. They then realised that the soil eaten in some areas did not contain a lot of minerals, and that in other areas plants were a better mineral source. Many people believe that the clay in soil can (12) _____ poisons. Indeed, clay-based (13) _____ are sold in African markets to treat a range of illnesses.

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Reading Passage 2

Speaking of Nothing

Why we talk about the weather and other trivia

Paragraph 1 Some workers are happier in their jobs than others, but it's not only to do with the work itself. For example, security guards, truck drivers and salespeople: year after year, these jobs appear on lists of the unhappiest careers. It's true that many factors can make a job cheerless, including unusual hours, low pay and a lack of chances for advancement. However, these three types of work stand out for another reason: they're characterised by a lack of conversation or by meaningless small talk, which unfortunately represents an obligatory part of the job. Examples of such small talk include comments about the weather, holiday destinations and food. Psychologists have long said that connecting with others through meaningful exchanges is central to well-being, but just how much conversation we require is under investigation.

Paragraph 2 Matthias R. Mehl and Simine Vazire of the University of Arizona in the United States wanted to investigate the types of conversations people have. The team used a device to periodically record short verbal exchanges while participants went about their daily tasks. In the study, the researchers eavesdropped on undergraduates for four days, then catalogued each overheard conversation as either 'small talk' or 'substantive'. They found that people who had more substantive conversations were more likely to say they were feeling happy and fulfilled overall. In fact, the happiest students had roughly twice as many substantive talks as the unhappiest ones. Small talk, meanwhile, made up only 10 per cent of their conversation, versus almost 30 per cent of conversation among the least content students.

Paragraph 3 However, small talk still has a role to play. Rather than convey information, scientists believe that it can promote bonding. Ipek Kulahci and her team of researchers at University College Cork in Ireland tested the relationship between vocal exchanges and grooming in lemurs. The researchers reported that the animals reserve their call-and-response conversations, equivalent to human chitchat, for the animals they groom the most - suggesting that small talk maintains closeness with loved ones, and isn't merely for awkward exchanges with strangers. It appears that, even among animals, vocal exchanges indicate strong social bonds between the group members.

Paragraph 4 Connecting with others seems to increase happiness, but strangers in close proximity routinely ignore each other. To examine the experience of connecting to strangers, psychologists Nicholas Epley and Juliana Schroeder from the University of Chicago in the United States gave volunteers varying directions about whether to talk with other commuters who usually took the same train to work every day - something they

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typically avoided. Those told to chat with others reported a more pleasant journey than those told to 'enjoy your solitude' or do whatever they normally would. All of the volunteers in the study who initiated conversations reported a positive reaction from the people they spoke to. Participants had predicted precisely the opposite outcome. They expected that the others on the train would have preferred to be left alone.

Paragraph 5 When we buy a cup of coffee at a cafe, we sometimes chat with the service staff, but on other occasions we say as little as possible so as not to waste time. Every day we have opportunities to transform potentially impersonal exchanges into genuine social interactions; in other words, treating a service provider like we would an acquaintance might make us happier. In a study by Gillian Sandstrom and Elizabeth Dunn, people who had a social interaction with a server in a coffee shop felt better emotionally than people who were in a rush to get everything done. As well as feeling happier, the first group had a stronger sense of belonging. In similar studies, when volunteers broke the silence at a gallery to chat with other visitors, the visitors felt happier and more connected to the paintings than those who were not approached. The pleasure of connection seems contagious; in a laboratory waiting room, participants who were talked to had equally positive experiences as those instructed to talk to them.

Paragraph 6 Of course, some of us are better than others at small talk. In a study by Todd Kashdan and his team from George Mason University in the United States, people who were rated by the researchers as 'less curious about all aspects of life' had trouble getting a conversation going on their own. However, they had greater luck building closeness with others when they were supplied with topics that encouraged people to open up about themselves and their lives. But people who were deemed 'curious' needed no help transforming conversations about ordinary things like favourite holidays into other areas of conversation that allowed for intimate exchanges. In an experiment by William Fleeson at Wake Forest University in the United States, participants were divided into two groups - those who were naturally outgoing, and those who were more reserved in social situations. They were then instructed to behave in the opposite manner to their usual nature. Participants reported more positive feelings when instructed to act extroverted than when instructed to act introverted. The overall conclusion, therefore, is that everyone can benefit from more conversation; the more meaningful, the better.

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Questions 14–19

Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.

LIST OF HEADINGS

i How sounds and physical contact strengthen social connections
ii A cross-cultural study of superficial interaction
iii An experiment that led to surprising results
iv A study that categorised types of spoken exchanges
v The personality types that find small talk more difficult
vi The effect of social media on conversation skills
vii Some occupations involve little or no interesting conversation
viii A campaign to improve interaction in the workplace
ix A range of common situations that were enhanced by small talk

Q	Paragraph	Answer
14	Paragraph 1	
15	Paragraph 2	
16	Paragraph 3	
17	Paragraph 4	
18	Paragraph 5	
19	Paragraph 6	

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Questions 20–23

Match each statement with the correct researcher, **A–E.**

LIST OF RESEARCHERS

A Matthias R. Mehl and Simine Vazire

B Ipek Kulahci

C Nicholas Epley and Juliana Schroeder

D Gillian Sandstrom and Elizabeth Dunn

E Todd Kashdan

Q	Statement	Answer
20	Interacting socially is preferable to hurrying through a transaction.	
21	People whose conversations are mainly of a personal and meaningful nature are more satisfied with their lives.	
22	There is more than one species whose members communicate for social reasons.	
23	Some people find it easier than others to change the subject of a conversation.	

Questions 24–26

Complete the sentences below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

In a study that took place on a train, volunteers approached people who were regular (24) _____

In an experiment in an art gallery, people related more to the (25) _____ when they were drawn into a conversation.

Introverted people found it helpful to be given (26) _____ which they could use to start a conversation.

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Reading Passage 3

Changes to the Soviet Union's Working Week

Paragraph 1 The Soviet Union's first Five Year Plan was intended to turn the weak and undeveloped country into a powerful, modern, industrial nation. Following its introduction in 1928, production of coal, iron and steel increased at a fantastic rate, and new industrial cities sprang up. Everyone's life was affected, as collectivised farming drove millions from the land to swell the industrial proletariat. Private enterprise disappeared in city and country, leaving the state supreme under the leadership of Stalin. Unlimited enthusiasm was the mood of the day, with the Communists believing that iron will and hard-working manpower alone would bring about a new world.

Paragraph 2 Not even time itself was immune to efforts to make the state a huge, efficient machine, where not a moment would be wasted, especially in the workplace. Stalin's predecessor Lenin had already been intrigued by the ideas of Taylor, the American management expert whose time and motion studies had discovered ways of streamlining effort so that every worker could produce the maximum. The Communists were also great admirers of Ford's assembly line mass production and of his tractors that were imported in their thousands. Emulating and surpassing such capitalist models formed part of the training of the new Soviet Man.

Paragraph 3 The goals of Communism had always included improving the lives of the proletariat. One major step in that direction was the announcement in 1927 that reduced the working day from eight to seven hours. In January 1929, all industries were ordered to adopt the shorter day by the end of the Plan. However, the state took away more than it gave, for this was part of a scheme to increase production by establishing a three-shift system, for six days a week. That meant that the factories were open day and night, and many people had to work at highly undesirable hours.

Paragraph 4 Hardly had that policy been announced, though, than the economist Larin came up with an idea for even greater efficiency. Workers were free and plants were closed on Sundays. Why not abolish that wasted day by instituting a continuous working week so that the machines could operate to their full capacity every day of the week? Stalin approved, and the continuous working week was introduced in August 1929 with immediate effect. This was during the height of enthusiasm for the Plan, whose goals the new schedule seemed guaranteed to forward.

The idea turned out to be very complicated in practice. Obviously, the workers couldn't be made to work seven days a week, nor should their total work hours be increased. The solution was ingenious: a new five-day week would have the workers on the job for four days, with the fifth day free. Staggering the rest days between groups of workers meant

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that each worker would spend the same number of hours on the job, but the factories would be working a full 360 days a year instead of 300. Workers in each establishment were divided into five groups, each assigned a colour which appeared on the new calendars distributed all over the country. This colour-coding was a valuable device, since without it workers might have trouble remembering what their day off was going to be, as it would change every week.

Paragraph 5 Official propaganda stressed the material and cultural benefits of the new scheme. Workers would get more rest; production and employment would increase; the standard of living would improve. Shopping and leisure activities would no longer have to be crammed into a weekend, so facilities would be far less crowded. The only objection concerned the family, where normally more than one member was working: the government insisted that the narrow family was far less important than the vast common good and, besides, arrangements could be made for husband and wife to share a common schedule.

Paragraph 6 The continuous working week spread fast, reaching its peak in October 1930, when it affected nearly three quarters of workers. In fact, many managers simply claimed that their factories had gone over to the new week, without actually applying it. By then, though, problems were becoming obvious. The workers hated it. Coordination of family schedules was virtually impossible, so husbands and wives only saw each other before or after work. Confusion reigned: the new plan was implemented haphazardly, with some factories operating five-, six- and seven-day weeks at the same time, and the workers often not getting their rest days at all.

Paragraph 7 Furthermore, the new week was far from having the vaunted effect on production. With the complicated rotation system, the work teams found themselves doing different kinds of work in successive weeks. Machines, no longer consistently in the hands of people who knew how to tend them, were often poorly maintained. Workers lost a sense of responsibility for the tasks they had normally performed. As a result, the new week started to lose ground.

Paragraph 8 In November 1931, the government ordered the widespread adoption of a new six-day week, including one day off, which had its own calendar. By July 1935, only a quarter of workers still followed the continuous schedule, and the six-day week too was soon on its way out. Both were finally abandoned in 1940, as part of the general reversion to more traditional methods, and Sunday returned as the universal day of rest. The experiment had failed.

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Questions 27–34

Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below. Example: Paragraph 3 — iii

LIST OF HEADINGS

i A decision for factories to operate seven days a week
ii The end of two short-lived schemes
iii An attempt to create better working conditions?
iv Not consistently introduced everywhere
v Success in replacing foreign goods
vi How the continuous working week was organised
vii Inspiration from abroad
viii A proposal by factory workers
ix Optimism about transforming the country
x The failure of factories to achieve expected improvements
xi Pros and cons of the continuous working week

Q	Paragraph	Answer
27	Paragraph 1	
28	Paragraph 2	
29	Paragraph 3	*iii (example)*
30	Paragraph 4	
31	Paragraph 5	
32	Paragraph 6	
33	Paragraph 7	
34	Paragraph 8	

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Questions 35–37

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**.

35 Which aspect of American business was admired?

A the high level of employment
B the variety of products available
C the methods of increasing productivity
D the quality of the goods that were produced

36 The continuous working week was intended to ensure that

A each worker's productivity increased.
B machinery was in continuous use.
C workers had more days off.
D factories could afford to buy efficient machines.

37 Which of the following was thought unlikely to improve as a result of the continuous working week?

A family life
B leisure facilities
C employment levels
D shopping opportunities

Questions 38–40

Answer the questions below. Write **NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS** *from the passage for each answer.*

What was the name of the person whose theories inspired efforts to increase efficiency?

38 _____

What was the name of the person who proposed the continuous working week?

39 _____

In calendars of the continuous working week, what system was used to identify different groups of workers? 40 _____

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 7

Volume 9 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Seaweed

Seaweed, a common plant that grows in the sea, has been an important food, fuel, and fertilizer since prehistoric times. For example, it has supplemented the diet of sheep in the Orkneys, islands off the coast of Scotland, since Neolithic times, roughly 5000 years ago. In the early part of the 8th century in Japan, seaweed was already such a key part of people's regular diet that legislation was introduced giving people the right to pay their taxes to the Emperor in the form of seaweed.

The oldest evidence of seaweed use was found in South America, dating from 12,500 years ago. The remains of red seaweed mixed with a medicinal herb were discovered on the floor of a medicine hut at Monte Verde, Chile, one of the oldest human habitation sites in the Americas. The Monte Verde findings led to a re-evaluation of the importance of plants to the communities of that region. It was previously believed that their diet was predominantly meat-based, and therefore reliant on the hunting skills of men. However, these findings suggest that women, known to be responsible for the gathering of plants such as seaweed, also played an important part in the provision of food.

The first recorded commercial use of seaweed in Europe was in the 17th century in France and Norway. Coastal populations, mainly farmers, gathered and burnt seaweed to produce potash, a substance which is used in the production of glass and soap. In 1800, Norway exported 1500 tonnes of potash.

Simple seaweed cultivation techniques were first developed in Japan in the mid-17th century and became increasingly popular over the next three centuries. In 1948, however, a series of typhoons combined with increased pollution in coastal waters led to a total collapse in Japanese production of nori, the type of seaweed used to make sushi. And because almost nothing was known about its life cycle, no one could figure out how to grow new plants from scratch to repopulate the depleted seaweed beds. The country's nori industry ground to a halt, and many farmers lost their livelihoods.

It was a British scientist, Dr Kathleen Drew-Baker, who was credited with saving Japan's seaweed farming industry. Based at Manchester University in the 1940s, she was studying a seaweed called laver, which is the Welsh equivalent of nori. In 1949, she published a paper outlining her discovery that certain tiny algae were actually baby seaweed, rather than an entirely separate species, as had previously been thought. After reading her

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research, Japanese scientists quickly developed methods for seeding these tiny algae artificially so that new plants could be grown. This made the mass production of nori possible. Although hardly anyone has heard of Dr Drew-Baker in the UK, she is known as the "Mother of the Sea" in Japan, and a statue of her can be found in the Japanese city of Osaka.

In the United States, Professor Charles Yarish of the University of Connecticut should probably be called the "Father of the Sea" for his work on kelp, a large brown seaweed. The renowned scientist, who has been studying the biology of seaweed since the early 1970s, recently turned his attention to the development of revolutionary techniques for the harvesting of this species. Yarish has helped make it an economically viable crop for the New England fishermen whose livelihoods were threatened by a combination of overfishing, pollution, and warming waters.

As the world population grows and the climate changes, there is increased interest from businesses and development organizations in the use of seaweed for food and energy. Seaweed, which can grow rapidly and efficiently, provides plant-based proteins, and could also be used as a source of biofuels to replace fossil fuels. Its ability to absorb a number of environmentally unfriendly chemicals discharged by farms, factories and wastewater treatment plants also makes it valuable as a means of reducing pollution.

Seaweed cultivation in Asia has grown from the late 1950s into an industry offering sustainable employment in developing and emerging economies in many countries, notably Indonesia and China. However, seaweed farming is not very well developed in Europe and the industry still relies on the harvesting, either manually or mechanically, of wild seaweed. The main constraints on the development of seaweed farming in Europe have been the lack of markets and the relative expense of European production compared to Asian production.

A 2016 report from the World Bank estimates that annual global seaweed production could reach 500 million dry tons by 2050 if the industry is able to increase its harvest by 14% per year. Hitting that 500 million mark would boost the world's food supply by 10% from the current level, generating 50 million jobs in the process. As a biofuel for vehicles, it could also replace about 1.5% of the fossil fuels used today.

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Questions 1–5

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage? Write **TRUE**, **FALSE** *or* **NOT GIVEN**.

1 Seaweed has been used to feed animals on some Scottish islands for thousands of years.

2 In the 8th century in Japan, eating seaweed was reserved for special occasions.

3 The findings at Monte Verde revealed new information about the significance of women's roles in prehistoric times.

4 Potash was Norway's largest export in the 1800s.

5 Dr Kathleen Drew-Baker is more famous in Japan than she is in the UK.

Questions 6–13

Complete the table below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Japanese seaweed industry
was destroyed by pollution and (6) ——— in 1948
recovered as a result of Kathleen Drew-Baker's research into (7) ———, a seaweed species similar to nori
Seaweed farming in the USA
new methods have resulted in the type of seaweed called (8) ——— becoming a successful crop
has provided an alternative source of income for (9) ———
Seaweed production in the future
may be used to minimise the harmful effects of various (10) ——— produced by different industries
the cost of production and shortage of (11) ——— may be preventing growth of the industry in Europe
could create very large numbers of new (12) ———
could be used instead of oil to power a small percentage of (13) ———

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Reading Passage 2

The History of the Celtic Language

A In November 1897, in a field near the village of Coligny in eastern France, a local inhabitant unearthed two strange objects. One was an imposing statue of Mars, the Roman god of war. The other was an ancient bronze tablet, 1.5 metres wide and 1 metre high. It bore numerals in Roman but the words were in Gaulish, a version of the Celtic language spoken by the inhabitants of France before the Roman conquest in the first century BC. The tablet turned out to be one of the most important sources of words from this extinct language.

B Two researchers, geneticist Dr Peter Forster and linguist Dr Alfred Toth, have now used the calendar and other Celtic inscriptions to reconstruct the history of Celtic and its position in the Indo-European family of languages. They say that Celtic became a language in its own right and entered the British Isles much earlier than supposed. Then in the first century BC, the Romans defeated the Celts, both in France and in Britain, so decisively that their language, Latin, and its successor languages displaced Celtic over much of its former territory. In the British Isles, Celtic speakers survived in two main groups: the Goidelic branch of Celtic, which includes Irish and Scots Gaelic, and the Brythonic branch, formed mainly of Welsh and Breton, a Celtic tongue carried to Brittany in France by emigrants from Cornwall.

C Because languages change so fast, historical linguists have little faith in language trees that go back more than a few thousand years. Dr Forster has developed a new dating method for relating a group of languages, basing it on the tree-drawing techniques used to trace the evolutionary relationships among genes. The method will work on just a handful of words, a fortunate circumstance since only some 30 Gaulish words have known counterparts in all the other languages under study. Dr Forster and Dr Toth have used the method to draw up a tree relating the different branches of Celtic to one another and to other Indo-European languages like English, French, Spanish, Latin and Greek. In a published article, they say that soon after the ancestral Indo-European language arrived in Europe over 5,000 years ago, it split into different branches leading to Celtic, Latin, Greek and English. Within Celtic, their tree shows that Gaulish, the mainland European version of the language, separated from its Goidelic and Brythonic cousins, much as might be expected from the facts of geography.

D The researchers' method even dates the points at which their language tree divides, although the dates have a wide range of possibility. They calculate that the Indo-European language initially fragmented in Europe around 8100 BC, plus or minus 1,900 years, and the divergence between the mainland European and British versions of Gaelic took place in

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3200 BC, plus or minus 1,500 years. These dates are much earlier than previously estimated. "The traditional date of the Indo-European fragmentation has been 4000 BC for some time," said linguist Dr Merritt Ruhlen. He said the new method "seems pretty reasonable" and should be useful in tracing back the earlier history of the Indo-European language.

E Specialists have long debated which country was the homeland of the Indo-Europeans and whether their language was spread by conquest or because its speakers were the first agriculturists whose methods and tongue were adopted by other populations. The second theory, that it was spread by agriculture, has been advocated by archaeologist Dr Colin Renfrew. Dr Forster, who works with Dr Renfrew, said in an interview that the suggested date 8100 BC for the arrival of Indo-European in Europe does seem to vindicate Renfrew's archaeological idea that the Indo-European languages were spread by farmers. Agriculture started to arrive in Europe from the Near East around 6000 BC, which is earlier than the traditional date proposed by linguists for the spread of Indo-European. This writing would fit with the lower end of Dr Forster's range of dates.

F Dr Forster said that his estimated date of 3200 BC for the arrival of Celtic speakers in the British Isles is also much earlier than the usual date, 600 BC, posited on the basis of archaeological evidence. Dr Forster and Dr Toth said their method of evaluating groups of languages against each other was similar to historical linguists, many of whom restrict their research to how words in only one single language have changed over time. Asked what linguists thought of his approach he said: "To be honest, they don't understand it, most of them. They don't even know what I'm talking about." The method used by Dr Forster and Dr Toth has two parts. One is to draw a tree on the basis of carefully chosen words; the second is to date the splits in the tree by calibrating them with known historical events. This is similar to the way geneticists date their evolutionary trees by tying one or more branch points to known dates from the fossil record.

G Dr April McMahon, a linguist at the University of Sheffield in England, said that Dr Forster's method "seems to me to be a good start", and that it was reasonable to base a language family tree on just a handful of well-chosen words. She had less confidence in the dating method, she said, because language changes in an irregular way based on social factors like the size of the speaker's group and its degree of contact with others.

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Questions 14–18

Which paragraph contains the following information? NB You may use any letter more than once.

Q	Statement	Answer
14	a difference of opinion about where a group of languages originated	
15	a reference to a mythological figure	
16	an expression of one person's doubt about a particular method of analysing scientific data	
17	an explanation of how one particular Celtic language spread due to the movement of people	
18	the reason why some language experts distrust language trees	

Questions 19–22

Match each statement with the correct researcher or researchers, **A–D**.

LIST OF RESEARCHERS

A Dr Peter Forster & Dr Alfred Toth

B Dr Merritt Ruhlen

C Dr Colin Renfrew

D Dr April McMahon

Q	Statement	Answer
19	An approach commonly used in language research has too narrow a focus.	
20	The number of people who use a language has an effect on the modifications the language undergoes.	
21	The Celtic language has been a distinct language for longer than experts previously thought.	
22	The use of one family of languages may have become more extensive due to farming practices.	

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Questions 23–26

Complete the sentences below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

The script on the bronze tablet discovered in Coligny in France was written in a form of Celtic called (23) _____

After the success of the Roman Empire in conquering many parts of Europe, (24) _____ and its related languages became the predominant languages.

(25) _____ is known to have occurred among the various versions of the Gaelic language around 3200 BC.

For social reasons, developments in languages are (26) _____

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Reading Passage 3

The Psychology of New Product Adoption

John Gourville explores the reasons why consumers don't always buy new products

An American philosopher once said, "If a man can ... make a better mousetrap than his neighbor ... the world will make a beaten path to his door." If only marketing innovation was that simple. In today's marketplace, companies that successfully introduce new products are more likely to flourish than those that don't. However, businesses spend billions of dollars making better "mousetraps" only to find consumers rejecting them. Studies show that new products fail at the staggering rate of between 40% and 90%. In the US packaged goods industry, for example, companies introduce 30,000 new products every year, but 70% to 90% of them stay on store shelves for less than 12 months. According to one study, 47% of the start-up companies that pioneered new products later went out of business altogether.

Experts and novices alike tend to dismiss unsuccessful innovations as bad ideas that were destined to fail. But surely that's too simple an explanation. If these innovations were so misguided, why wasn't it obvious from the outset? Why don't consumers buy innovative products with distinct advantages over existing ones? To understand why new products fail we must delve into the psychology of behavior change.

Companies have long assumed that they have only to develop innovations that are objectively superior to existing products, and consumers will have sufficient incentive to purchase them. In the 1960s, communications scholar Everett Rogers called the concept "relative advantage" and identified it as the most critical driver of new-product adoption. Although compelling, the theory has one major flaw: it fails to capture the psychological biases that affect decision-making. In 2002, psychologist Daniel Kahneman won the Nobel Prize in economics for his research into the reasons why individuals deviate from rational economic behavior. One of the cornerstones of that research, developed with psychologist Amos Tversky, is how individuals value choices in the marketplace. Kahneman and Tversky showed that our responses to the alternatives before us have four distinct characteristics.

First, people evaluate the attractiveness of an alternative based not on its objective or actual value, but on its subjective or perceived value. Second, consumers evaluate new products relative to the products they already own. Third, people view any improvements relative to this reference point and treat all shortcomings as losses. Fourth, and most important, losses have a far greater impact on people than similarly sized gains, a phenomenon that Kahneman and Tversky called "loss aversion". Loss aversion leads

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people to value products they already possess more than those that they don't. In other words, our desire to keep what we have is far greater than our desire to gain something new.

In a 1990 paper, behavioral economist Richard Thaler and his colleagues described a series of experiments they conducted to quantify this phenomenon. In one experiment, they gave coffee mugs to a group of people, the "Sellers", and asked at what price point, from $0.25 to $9.25, they would be willing to part with those mugs. The researchers then asked another group, the "Choosers", to whom they didn't give coffee mugs, to indicate whether they would choose the money or the mug at each price point. In objective terms, all the Sellers and the Choosers were in the same situation: they were choosing between a mug and a sum of money. In one trial the Sellers priced the mug at $7.12, on average, but the Choosers were willing to pay only $3.12. In another trial, the Sellers and the Choosers valued the mug at $7 and $3.50, respectively. Overall, the Sellers always demanded at least twice as much to give up the mugs as the Choosers would pay to obtain them.

In a 1989 paper, economist Jack Knetsch helped to explain why people tend to stick with what they have even if a better alternative exists, by providing a compelling demonstration of what is known as the "status quo bias". Knetsch asked one group of students to choose between an attractive coffee mug and a bar of Swiss chocolate. He gave a second group the coffee mugs but later allowed each student to exchange their mugs for a chocolate bar. Finally, Knetsch gave chocolate bars to a third group then later allowed them to exchange their bars for a mug. Of the students initially given a choice, 56% chose the mug and 44% chose the chocolate bar, indicating a near even split in preferences between the two products. Logically, therefore, about half of the students to whom Knetsch gave the coffee mug should have traded for the chocolate bar and vice versa. However, in reality, only 11% of the students with mugs and 10% of those with chocolate bars wanted to exchange their products. To approximately 90% of the students, giving up what they already had seemed like a painful loss and reduced their desire to trade.

Interestingly, most people seem oblivious to the existence of the behaviors implicit in these biases. In study after study, when researchers presented people with evidence that they had irrationally overvalued what they had, they were shocked, skeptical and more than a little defensive. These behavioral tendencies are universal, but awareness of them is not.

In a perfect world, companies would know that consumers irrationally overvalue incumbent products and would take that bias into account when launching innovations. But developers are also biased - in favor of new products. Having worked on a new product for years, developers operate in a world where their innovation is the reference point.

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They're convinced that the product works and they are keenly aware of the shortcomings of existing alternatives. Companies call those developers "product champions" or "believers", suggesting that they have embraced a world the rest of us haven't yet.

Questions 27–32

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**.

27 In the first paragraph, what are we told about the current US marketplace?

A Almost half of all businesses that added new products collapse.
B Innovations in packaged goods have the greatest chance of success.
C It is a waste of money to invent new versions of products that already work well.
D The least successful companies are those that concentrate on existing products.

28 In the second paragraph, what does the writer say about unsuccessful innovations?

A Companies should take advice from the experts.
B Innovations fail if companies lack business experience.
C The failure of many innovations can be predicted from the beginning.
D The reasons for product failure are more complex than is commonly thought.

29 According to the characteristics described by Kahneman and Tversky, consumers

A compare new products with things they have bought previously.
B value new products more than ones they currently own.
C give up what they already have quite willingly.
D consider price more than any other factor.

30 What are we told about the experiment conducted by Richard Thaler and his colleagues?

A The Choosers had to guess the correct price of the coffee mug.
B The Sellers valued their coffee mugs more than the Choosers did.
C The Sellers had to persuade the Choosers to buy their coffee mugs.
D The Choosers paid less money for their coffee mugs than the Sellers.

31 In Jack Knetsch's demonstration, the second group of students were:

A given a choice of several different products at the beginning.
B asked to choose between what they had and a new product.
C allowed to keep both of the products they were shown.
D forced to give back the first product they had been given.

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32 What was the end result of Knetsch's demonstration?

A The majority of students reacted in a logical way.

B Most of the students preferred chocolate bars to coffee mugs.

C Almost all of the students were unwilling to swap their products.

D Half of the students with coffee mugs swapped them for chocolate bars.

Questions 33–35

Complete each sentence with the correct ending, **A–F**, *below.*

ENDINGS

A consumers do not follow expected purchasing patterns.

B people will always buy products that are better than those they already own.

C consumers value objective quality more than personal ownership.

D consumers have their own idea of the value of a product.

E start-up companies rarely understand product development.

F developers are unaffected by psychological bias.

Q	Sentence start	Answer
33	The theory of relative advantage is based on the assumption that	
34	The 2002 Nobel Prize for economics was awarded for a study that explained why	
35	According to the first characteristic described by Kahneman and Tversky,	

Questions 36–40

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer? Write **YES**, **NO** *or* **NOT GIVEN**.

36 Everett Rogers' theory explains the psychology behind the choices consumers make.

37 "Loss aversion" helps to explain why people fail to buy new products.

38 Developers always believe their latest product will be a success.

39 Developers waste too much time perfecting new products.

40 A product champion is a person who develops a best-selling new product.

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 8

Volume 9 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Australia's Airborne Dentists

Australians living or traveling in rural and remote areas can face particular difficulties when they need medical care. Hundreds of kilometres from major cities and many hours by road from the closest hospital or clinic, some rural Australians do not have easy access to doctors, nurses and dentists.

Organisations such as the Royal Flying Doctor Service (RFDS) have been established to bring health services to outback Australian communities. The RFDS provides free medical care to people who live, work or travel in remote and regional parts of Australia. This non-profit organisation is the oldest and largest airborne health service of its kind in the world, and since 1928 it has used small planes to reach Australia's most far-away communities.

In recent years, the RFDS has also started to fly dentists to regional Australia. As well as offering mobile dental clinics, the RFDS offers a range of preventative and educational services. Looking after the teeth of people in remote areas presents special challenges. These include providing care to disparate communities with no established dental facilities, and dealing with higher incidences of other diseases which are linked to, or caused by poor dental health.

People in remote areas have very infrequent visits by health staff. RFDS dentists might only visit a community once every few months, or sometimes once per year. Because of infrequent dentist visits, patients in these areas often need to put up with their dental problems before they can get treatment; consequently, people in remote areas are more likely to have tooth decay (the blackening and deterioration of teeth) and develop gum and other mouth diseases.

In some locations that the RFDS visits, there are no suitable dental facilities, so dentists have to bring everything with them. This includes drills, dentists' chairs, portable X-ray machines, and computers for keeping track of patients' treatments. Equipment can weigh up to 100 kilograms, and since the small planes that transport dentists have limited space, dentists cannot always bring everything that they need.

While dentists in town or city centres can specialise in certain types of treatment, RFDS dentists need to be 'all-rounders'. They need to be able to do all kinds of dental procedures, as they don't have the ability to refer patients to more specialised dentists. Even with their

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broad experience, there are some services that are particularly challenging for RFDS dentists. For example, dentures (artificial teeth) can be very difficult to provide, as they need to be the right shape and size for the patient, and this requires many visits over a long period of time. As a result, it is not practical to make dentures available.

Some chronic illnesses are more common in remote communities than in the rest of Australia. These illnesses can in turn lead to a lowered resistance to infection, including gum and other oral infections. As a result, people in outback Australian communities are more likely to experience oral health problems than city folk, and this poses extra challenges for both the dentists and the doctors of the RFDS.

Because there aren't a lot of dental services in remote areas, people living in these areas also receive less education about good dental hygiene than their city counterparts do. Australians in very remote communities might not be aware of things that people in cities take for granted, such as the importance of daily tooth brushing. Also, basic dental hygiene items such as toothpaste and toothbrushes can be more expensive in outback areas. Many people are on low incomes, meaning they have extra difficulty affording these products. If this is the case, the RFDS supplies these.

As well as treating patients, RFDS dentists try to focus on preventative oral health and educate their patients on good oral hygiene, such as tooth brushing and flossing. The RFDS also provides mouthguards for young sports players. Playing contact sports, such as rugby league or Australian rules football, can damage young people's teeth, so mouthguards provide protection which prevents accidental injuries.

Adding fluoride to water supplies has been proven to reduce the incidence of tooth decay in many parts of the world. City dwellers in Australia use water supplies that have been fluoridated, and their rates of tooth decay are lower because of this. In remote areas, it is not practical to fluoridate drinking water supplies, and so people living in these areas are more subject to tooth decay. As a result, it is particularly important that people living in areas without fluoridated water pay special attention to regular brushing of their teeth with fluoridated toothpaste.

Despite many challenges, the RFDS continues to offer much-needed dental and medical support. Its presence in isolated communities greatly improves the quality of dental health, and supports important oral hygiene and health initiatives.

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Questions 1–7

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage? Write **TRUE**, **FALSE** *or* **NOT GIVEN**.

1. Many of the RFDS doctors work as volunteers.
2. RFDS dentists make trips to outback communities each month.
3. RFDS dentists are accompanied on their journeys to remote areas by a dental nurse.
4. RFDS dentists must provide a wide range of dental services.
5. Rural dental patients are more informed about oral hygiene than urban patients.
6. RFDS dentists educate patients about good eating habits.
7. Urban Australians generally have better teeth because their water is treated.

Questions 8–13

Complete the notes below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Challenges and Support

CHALLENGES FACED BY RFDS DENTISTS

- need to bring equipment including (8) ——— for records
- aircraft used to carry equipment have restricted (9) ———
- problems offering some services, e.g., fitting (10) ———
- people in remote areas are more likely to have infection in their mouth

PRODUCTS SUPPLIED BY RFDS DENTISTS

- if necessary RFDS provides: (11) ——— and (12) ——— for regular use
- (13) ——— to limit dental accidents on the sports field

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Reading Passage 2

Public Art Programs: Research Update

A Researcher Howard Spector suggests that active art experiences benefit all age groups by providing individuals with the means to freely and creatively express themselves. Self-expression, in turn, promotes individuality, bolsters self-confidence and improves motivation and attitudes towards academic performance. Both active and passive art experiences can provide the benefits of discovery, stimulation and relaxation (Oliphant 2000). Furthermore, people's participation in art enhances their development and expands their thoughts about culture. In short, art can make individuals more socially conscious.

B Communities committed to providing opportunities for experiencing art are considered more livable because they are attractive to businesses and industry and they offer a higher quality of life for residents (Riley 2002). Tourism is strongly linked to art; art is believed to stimulate tourism in a community, and vice versa. Art-related tourism generates tourists and revenue, attracts high-income consumers, extends the tourist season and is a 'green' form of the industry (Hughes 2000). Revitalization efforts have increased in many cities because of the strong presence of art opportunities. Art programs can be highly effective in reducing community problems related to delinquent behavior and truancy in youth (Spector 2000). The Philadelphia Department of Recreation Mural Arts Program (MAP) is one such program. It began in the early 1980s when the city undertook to remove graffiti in the city while creating a positive, productive and creative outlet for adjudicated graffiti artists, as they used their talents to beautify public spaces through the creation of murals, instilling a sense of pride, excellence, diligence and civic responsibility.

C In recognition of these and other benefits, communities are finding many ways to ensure that the public is provided with opportunities to experience art. Public art programs are one way. These programs are typically administered by government, which commissions or mandates works of art for display in public spaces. Public art works can include street furniture, decorations, paving and landmarks, and may take on many forms, including sculpture, decorative ironwork, mosaic flooring and murals. The primary purpose of public art is to bring art into everyday life, to energize public spaces and to arouse society's thinking and imagination.

D Despite the significant benefits that art participation can offer to individuals and communities, only 35 percent of the American adult population visit museums or galleries at least once during the year, and only about 25 percent attend a live performance (Bradshaw 1998). Even fewer (14 percent) participate directly in photography, painting, drawing, sculpting, dance (other than ballet), creative writing or classical music. If art

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experiences are so beneficial, why aren't more people participating? To help researchers shed light on this question, the RAND Corporation, a nonprofit institution that helps improve policy and decision-making through objective research and analysis, developed 'A Behavior Model of the Participant Decision', which can be used to investigate people's inclinations about participating in an art activity (Yoshitomi 2000). According to Yoshitomi, each person has a disposition related to his or her interest in engaging in an art activity; a person's disposition is based on sociodemographic characteristics, social or cultural identity, personality and previous experience. The RAND model clusters participants into three groups according to their disposition toward art participation: those disinclined to participate; those inclined to participate; and those currently participating.

E The RAND findings reveal that the disinclined perceive themselves as being uncomfortable or unfamiliar with art. This disposition might occur among people who do not value art and who have not received art education, or who perceive themselves as unsophisticated or lacking skill to participate. The inclined are interested in participating, but may be constrained by particular barriers such as cost, time, and proper attire. Current participants are those who are involved, and influence or encourage others to participate. Researchers suggest that a strong relationship exists between childhood and adult art participation rates. Individuals with a greater number of childhood art experiences are more likely to have higher rates of participation as adults. Although 90 percent of Americans believe art instruction is important for children and should be offered in schools, almost 40 percent of schools either offer no art instruction or have art instructors with no formal art training.

F One recreation organization working to make sure children get exposed to art is the Boys and Girls Clubs of America, which offer two innovative programs: The National Photography Program and the National Fine Arts Exhibit. Both are designed to get children excited about art. The photography program promotes new art that is technologically produced, including video and computer graphics, but primarily focuses on photography. The program provides club members with the opportunity to achieve personal growth and receive artistic recognition through instruction in photography. Participants also display their work at local, regional and national photography contests. The second program is the Fine Arts Exhibit. This encourages artistic expression, creativity, cultural appreciation and the development of artistic skills through classes, special events, exhibits and competitions. It allows participants to explore a variety of mediums, including drawing, painting, print making, collage and sculpture. Because art experiences provide so many important benefits to individuals and communities, it is important for community programs to facilitate opportunities and provide encouragement to increase participation in a variety of programs.

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Questions 14–19

Reading Passage 2 has six paragraphs, **A–F**. *Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.*

LIST OF HEADINGS

i Interpreting the research behind who is participating in art activities
ii How sales of artwork have increased in many countries
iii Two opportunities for getting kids involved in art activities
iv How art can be made accessible to the public
v Developing a model to explain the lack of participation in art
vi The connection between art and media
vii How involvement with art affects well-being and attitudes
viii How art makes communities safer and more vital

Q	Paragraph	Answer
14	Paragraph A	
15	Paragraph B	
16	Paragraph C	
17	Paragraph D	
18	Paragraph E	
19	Paragraph F	

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Questions 20–23

Look at the following statements and the list of researchers below. Match each statement with the correct researcher, **A–E**.

LIST OF RESEARCHERS

A Spector
B Oliphant
C Riley
D Hughes
E Bradshaw

Q	Statement	Answer
20	Art activities can contribute to lowering negative incidents associated with juvenile crime.	
21	Art can bring money and visitors into a community.	
22	Commercial interests are drawn to areas that emphasize public art.	
23	Art activities can both energize and calm people.	

Questions 24–26

Complete the sentences below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

Sometimes people want to get involved in art activities but can't afford it, can't fit it into their schedule, or don't have the suitable (24) _____

A noticeable correlation exists between art involvement in childhood and those in adulthood (25) _____

The National Photography Program allows members to grow personally and also gain (26) _____

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Reading Passage 3

200 Years of Australian Landscapes at the Royal Academy in London

This exhibition promises to chart the evolution of a nation through its art, but not everyone agrees with the reasons behind the choice of artwork

A For the casual viewer, the exhibition of landscapes, Australia, selected by the Royal Academy of Art will be a spectacular guide through Australian art history. Included in the exhibition are a range of artists and styles, dating from the earliest days of colonial art and progressing through expressionism and modernism to the artists of the 20th century, culminating with the current generation of Australian artists. It is hardly surprising, then, that this results in a flexible, wide-ranging notion of landscape.

B But this landmark exhibition gives rise to some questions, and perhaps problems, regarding Britain's relationship with its former colony. By choosing a style of painting at which British artists excel, the Academy could be seen as inviting criticism that hints at a telling attitude towards art by comparison. But it is the very theme of landscape painting that makes this a controversial selection. To consider if condescending is perhaps too strong, but for Joanna Mendelssohn, Australian critic and Associate Professor at the University of NSW's College of Fine Arts (COFA), there is a suggestion that British artistic values have directed this exhibition, rather than allowing Australia the freedom to demonstrate its maturity.

C What Mendelssohn found surprising about the exhibition was the underlying rules for the selection of works seemed to have been so conservative. Since the landscape is a very strong British artistic theme, it appeared to her that when the British looked to the art of a former colony, there was a tendency for them to think that those colonies would continue to be like the British themselves. In reviewing Australian art, the British insisted on looking at the genre of landscape painting.

D Because of colonial ties, it was inevitable during Australian art's formative years that it would reflect Britain's devotion to the beloved landscape before its own character and idiosyncrasies took shape. And while Mendelssohn's concern over the exhibition's conventional selection is valid, the Academy is nevertheless embracing the peculiarities of Australian art from the mid-19th century onward, albeit within the boundaries of landscape.

E Australia is curated by Kathleen Soriano, director of exhibitions at the Royal Academy. 'Certainly the influence of English, French or German art is much more evident in the early periods, in the early 1800s to mid-1800s,' she says. 'What I wanted to show was how Australian art develops a real distinctiveness, associated with the landscape and the light.'

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F The fusion of 'tradition' of the European kind with something more specifically Australian, and often personal, is crucial to the exhibition and extends particularly to some of the more contemporary artists involved. Sydney-born video artist Shaun Gladwell is a good example of this. Gladwell's most famous piece, which is featured in the exhibition, is Storm Sequence (2000), a video of Gladwell skateboarding on the Bondi seafront as one of Sydney's signature brutal storms lingers offshore. It is his acknowledgment of landscape (or seascape) tradition, coloured by Gladwell's own individualism. 'To exhibit my work in this show might make some sense because I was interested in Turner and the idea of atmosphere affecting vision, something I was really interested in around the time of Storm Sequence. I was thinking about this tradition of Romantic landscape, but I wanted to make it personal,' says Gladwell. But he didn't want to just embark on borrowing imagery from elsewhere. He wanted to bring it to his experience and his world through skateboarding and beach culture.

G So while it may seem narrow for Britain to reduce Australian art to the genre of landscape, there can be little denying that British landscape painting is still relevant to a current generation of Australian practitioners, however indirectly.

H Visitors to the exhibition encounter Australian Aboriginal art first, the idea being that these works warrant a prominent position because they were 'first'. Over the last couple of decades, London has hosted many successful exhibitions of Aboriginal art in smaller spaces, but for Soriano, Australia represents an opportunity to place such art within the context of new relationships to the art of the settlers and white Australia. 'One of the reasons landscape was seen as being the right theme was because Australian art started in and on the landscape,' she says. '[The exhibition] is a beautiful meshing of the two different kinds of art that allowed me to bring them together comfortably and honestly with this theme. It was important for me to present Indigenous art to audiences, and I felt it was most accurate to be seen as part of Australian art history, rather than a separate exhibition of its own.'

I Meanwhile, Australian critic Mendelssohn also points out that London is increasingly less important to today's generation of artists, and this somewhat weakens the ceremony surrounding the exhibition in London. 'China is the most important art market in the world,' she says. 'If you've made it in Shanghai, you've made it. The world has changed. My students in Australia, who come from all over the world, really want to see Venice Biennale and Art Basel, but they're less interested in going to London. When I was growing up, London was the destination, and then when I was at university all the smart young things wanted to go to New York,' she added. 'Now they want to go everywhere. There's no such thing as the centre and the periphery like there used to be. It's much more complicated.'

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Questions 27–31

Do the following statements agree with the views of the writer in the passage? Write **YES**, **NO** *or* **NOT GIVEN**.

27 As expected, the artworks chosen for the exhibition reflect a narrow interpretation of landscape.

28 The Academy rejected Australian suggestions for the subject of the exhibition.

29 The colonial relationship meant that early Australian landscape painting followed the traditions of English landscape painting.

30 The exhibition reflects the fact that Australian art developed its own particular qualities.

31 Contemporary Australian artists have generally rejected British landscape traditions.

Questions 32–36

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**.

32 What is the writer's main point in the second paragraph?

A Australian landscape painting derives from the British tradition.
B Australian landscape painting is more highly regarded than British.
C Britain is still imposing its principles on Australian art.
D British art cannot be compared to Australian art.

33 What does Joanna Mendelssohn find surprising?

A Modern Australian landscape painting has great variety.
B The guidelines for the choice of work were very traditional.
C Landscape painting remains a popular subject for British artists.
D The British find the Australian landscape unsuitable as a subject.

34 Shaun Gladwell's work is included in the exhibition because

A it adopts a subjective approach to depicting the landscape.
B skateboarding is an inspiration to many Australian artists.
C storms are a significant feature in the Australian landscape.
D Bondi is an iconic Australian location.

35 What was the reason for Soriano including Aboriginal art in the exhibition?

A It is not well known in London art circles.
B Aboriginal landscape painting influenced Australian settlers.
C It is part of the Australian art tradition and not independent of it.
D Modern Aboriginal painting deals with changes to the landscape.

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36 By referring to China, Mendelssohn is making the point that

A having an exhibition in London is not as important as it used to be.

B young artists in Britain are not interested in Australian art.

C art from Shanghai is more important than Australian art.

D New York is still a preferred destination for young artists.

Questions 37–40

Complete each sentence with the correct ending, **A–F**, *below.*

ENDINGS

A reflects the mood created by the natural environment.

B demonstrates that the dominant art form in Australia is landscape painting.

C demonstrates an understanding of the historical importance of the land.

D showcases a very small number of artists.

E demonstrates a strong European flavour.

F shows an acceptance of the unique qualities of Australian art.

Q	Sentence start	Answer
37	In spite of its conservatism, the Royal Academy exhibition	
38	Australian art of the early to mid-1800s	
39	The modern work by Gladwell chosen for the exhibition	
40	Including Aboriginal art in the exhibition	

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IELTS Academic Reading — Test 9

Volume 9 · 3 Passages · 40 Questions

Reading Passage 1

Cranberry Fruit

The story of a unique North American crop

Cranberries are among the few fruits native to North America that have been grown commercially for centuries. These small, crimson berries thrive only in very unique environmental conditions, particularly in soil that is both sandy and acidic. Such terrain lets water pass through easily while still retaining enough moisture for the plants' shallow roots. Since ordinary farmland cannot provide this delicate balance, cranberries are generally cultivated in low-lying areas called bogs. These natural basins, bordered by gentle ridges, allow growers to regulate water levels accurately. This setup creates a growing environment quite different from that required by most other fruit crops.

Many bogs now used for cranberry farming were formed thousands of years ago when retreating glaciers carved deep hollows known as kettle ponds. Over time, these basins became lined with layers of sand and clay, producing a natural filtration system that keeps many pollutants out of the water. The clay bottom acts as a protective barrier, preventing harmful substances from entering the pond and preserving the clean water essential for healthy vines. Such geological conditions, combined with deliberate human control of water, have made kettle-pond sites especially well suited to this crop.

Long before the arrival of European settlers, the Wampanoag people made practical use of the berry in several ways. The fruit's sharp taste lent itself to preservation techniques; communities developed methods of drying and combining cranberries with other foods to extend their usefulness during months when fresh plants were scarce. These practices resulted in compact foodstuffs intended for consumption in colder seasons. In addition to dietary uses, the Wampanoag also employed the berry in first-aid traditions: crushed fruit was applied to sores and minor wounds, reflecting a practical knowledge of its cleansing properties.

When Europeans first arrived in the seventeenth century, they found cranberries in many coastal hollows and quickly took note of their usefulness. Rather than attempting to transplant European varieties, the newcomers adopted the native species already adapted to regional conditions. Colonists used the fruit in preserves and beverages and valued it for its nutritional contributions during winter voyages and inland shortages. Over time, cranberries were assimilated into colonial cookery and later became associated with

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holiday traditions in North America. In the early nineteenth century, the shift from gathering wild berries to planned cultivation accelerated thanks to local experimentation. One Massachusetts grower, Captain Henry Hall, observed that windblown sand reaching his beds improved fruit quality and yield. He began deliberately applying sand to his plots and found that the practice changed both soil texture and pest incidence for the better. Hall's practice of controlling the land and surface materials was an important step toward systematic cranberry farming.

Cranberry cultivation follows a seasonal routine that links each operation to weather patterns. In winter farmers often choose to flood the bogs, forming a protective layer that freezes and insulates the vines from extreme cold and drying winds. On the frozen surface, sand is sometimes scattered so that, when thawed, the particles work into the bed and improve overall drainage, encouraging fresh shoots to establish. To reduce disease risk and improve crop vigour, farmers also remove trees and scrub beside the bogs so that air can move through the site more freely and humidity is kept low.

With the coming of spring, the frozen cover is managed and water levels are adjusted; controlled water applications may be used at vulnerable times to shield budding shoots from sudden frosts. During this phase growers perform routine maintenance on channels, pumps and irrigation lines and take steps to reduce pest pressure before the plants enter full growth. By early summer the vines are active and the focus shifts toward ensuring the fruit matures evenly. Farmers inspect beds for any sign of weed emergence that would compete with the crop for nutrients and light, removing intruders promptly to protect potential yields.

As autumn nears, ripening fruit signals the approach of harvest. In many operations the bogs are flooded again so that the buoyant berries float and can be separated from the vines, easing collection. Although mechanical aids and modern equipment have changed some details of the work, the overall system continues to depend on balancing soil, water and human management. From the Wampanoag's early practical uses to the innovations of later growers, cranberry culture remains rooted in seasonal attention and careful control of a unique landscape.

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Questions 1–7

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage? Write **TRUE**, **FALSE** *or* **NOT GIVEN**.

1 The cranberry requires a specific soil type to enable it to grow successfully.

2 A layer of clay protects kettle ponds from harmful substances which could affect the water quality.

3 In the past, the Wampanoag people had to consume most cranberries shortly after picking them.

4 The Wampanoag people took advantage of the medicinal properties of cranberries.

5 The first settlers in North America brought European varieties of cranberry with them when they arrived.

6 Captain Hall tried growing other fruit crops before cultivating cranberries.

7 It took a long time for Captain Hall's methods of cultivation to become popular among other cranberry producers.

Questions 8–13

Complete the notes below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

The Cycle of Cranberry Production

WINTER

- Growers 8 ——— the bogs to protect vines.
- Sand is put on bogs to increase 9 ——— and encourage growth.
- Trees are removed to promote the movement of 10 ———.

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SPRING

- (11) ——— is supplied to protect against frost.
- (12) ——— is done to control pests.

SUMMER

- Growers check for (13) ——— growth.

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Reading Passage 2

Dark Chocolate's Health-giving Benefits

Researchers are investigating whether taking dark chocolate daily can reduce the risk of heart disease and stroke

A Dark chocolate is gaining a reputation as a heart-healthy food, and research suggests that there might be some substance behind those claims. Ginger Hultin, owner of Champagne Nutrition in Seattle and a spokesperson for the Academy of Nutrition and Dietetics says 'Cocoa contains antioxidants in addition to magnesium, potassium, zinc, and iron. Plus, studies have shown that there could be some benefit to consuming chocolate or cocoa for the cardiovascular system, including potentially lowering blood pressure.'

B Dark chocolate's health benefits come from its cocoa – specifically its cocoa flavanols. Flavanols are a type of polyphenol, and polyphenols are one group of phytochemicals. Many fruits and vegetables contain flavanols, but they are especially rich in tea, wine, and cocoa. During digestion, cocoa is broken down into smaller chemical compounds. Some research suggests that these compounds have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties and may help protect against cardiovascular disease, which affects both the heart and brain. For example, research has found that even two weeks of eating dark chocolate or other flavanol-rich cocoa products is better than a placebo for lowering blood pressure in people who already have high blood pressure, although not to normal levels. In 2013, the European Food Safety Authority approved the claim that cocoa flavanols help maintain normal blood pressure, which means that the cost involved in future medical treatment may be less than scientists previously predicted.

C Researchers have also pointed out that people may digest cocoa differently. Variations in gut bacteria can influence how flavanols are processed and absorbed in the body. As a result, the health effects of cocoa may differ from person to person, depending on individual digestive systems and dietary habits.

D Data from the long-running Physicians' Health Study suggests that chocolate intake is associated with a reduced risk of developing Type 2 diabetes in younger and normal-weight men. However, take those findings with a grain of salt, because they were based on a single question about average yearly intake of chocolate that didn't ask what type of chocolate — white, milk, or dark — says Howard Sesso, an associate professor of preventive medicine at Brigham and Woman's Hospital in Boston. 'If we assume that any benefits from cocoa are attributable to its flavanol content, then dark chocolate should in theory confer greater benefits than milk chocolate.' Sesso and other researchers are investigating whether taking daily supplements of 600 mg of cocoa flavanols — not

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chocolate itself — reduces the risk for developing heart disease and stroke, as well as cancer. However, they have yet to determine how much people need to consume to reap benefits.

E What does that mean for the average person who enjoys chocolate and hopes they're getting some health benefit from it? Sadly, results from the large European Prospective Investigation of Cancer, EPIC-Norfolk study suggest that the amount of flavanols that the average person in Europe or the United States consumes is unlikely to do much to reduce risk of cardiovascular disease compared with taking medicine. The research also suggested that certain groups, particularly overweight individuals, may not receive the same protective effects from chocolate consumption as younger and normal-weight men.

F Even though cocoa is a key ingredient in milk and dark chocolate, you can't really be sure how many flavanols you're getting. 'Product packaging does not specify amounts of cocoa flavanols, only percent cacao,' Sesso says. 'Variable processing of the cocoa bean makes it difficult to equate percent cacao with cocoa flavanol content.' White chocolate contains no cocoa solids, milk chocolate contains relatively small amounts of cocoa, while dark chocolate contains a much higher percentage of cocoa. Cocoa may also appear in the form of cocoa powder, cocoa butter, or concentrated cocoa extracts.

G In the meantime, remember that chocolate products are typically high in calories and fats; therefore, Sesso says it's best not to think of dark chocolate as a health food. 'Moderation is key; if someone enjoys eating chocolate, it should be done in moderation along with other foods.' So for now, it's best not to put all your flavanol eggs in a dark chocolate basket. 'We get different phytochemicals and antioxidants from a wide variety of foods,' Hultin says. 'Including different colors of fruits, vegetables, whole grains and beans is the best way to gain access to fiber that could support health.' That said, she does recommend enjoying a bit of chocolate or cocoa. 'I put cocoa powder in my smoothies for an added boost of flavor, nutrients and antioxidants.'

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Questions 14–18

Reading Passage 2 has seven paragraphs, **A–G**. *Which paragraph contains the following information?*

Q	Statement	Answer
14	a description of different kinds of cocoa used in chocolate production	
15	an explanation that chemicals produced during cocoa digestion may reduce the risks of diseases	
16	a reference to a group of people who may not benefit from eating chocolate	
17	an example of a specific way cocoa can be added into beverage	
18	information about differences in the way people digest cocoa	

Questions 19–22

Match each statement with the correct person or organization, **A–D**.

LIST OF PEOPLE OR ORGANIZATIONS

A Ginger Hultin
B European Food Safety Authority
C Howard Sesso
D EPIC-Norfolk

Q	Statement	Answer
19	Eating cocoa together with dietary fiber may improve health.	
20	Dark chocolate consumption could reduce medical spending in the future.	
21	Dark chocolate should not be considered a replacement for medicine.	
22	The amount of cocoa required for health benefits remains uncertain.	

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Questions 23–26

Complete the sentences below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** *from the passage for each answer.*

The digestive process turns cocoa into less complex chemical (23) _____

The (24) _____ would vary according to chocolate type with dark chocolate outperforming milk chocolate.

Dark chocolate should not be regarded as healthy due to its richness of calories and (25) _____

In Hultin's view, dietary diversity is the best strategy for acquiring (26) _____

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Reading Passage 3

All in the Family

A person's brothers and sisters can have a powerful effect on their adult behaviour

We can choose our friends, the saying goes, but we cannot choose our family of origin. Our parents provide the genetic material and make powerful early role models, but even more influential in determining what kind of adult we will become are our brothers and sisters — our siblings. They occupy a position of unique intimacy in our lives and cast a longer shadow than many recognize or are prepared to acknowledge. By turns enraging and lovable, familiar and mysterious, our brothers and sisters are the human beings who people our first social relationships. And a sibling relationship is the most enduring relationship many of us will ever have, less emotionally intense than the bonds we form with our spouses and our own children if only because they started when we were so young.

Surprising new research by Dr Gene Brody found that having older children who do well in school and are well liked by other children leads to parental 'basking' — increasing mothers' self-esteem. It is clear that in turn this is associated with more positive parenting of younger children, who display fewer behavioural problems as a result. Conversely, parents who get a difficult first child may in turn experience a negative spiral of household tension.

International sports star Piri Weepu is a rugby hard man, but at least some of his tough temperament was forged long ago in the family home. His older brother Billy started rugby-tackling little Piri when he was just four — to 'harden him up'. It seemed to work: Piri followed his brother in playing for the under-sevens league before he even started school. There are as many such stories as there are families: in the formative hothouse of the family, siblings interact in complex ways with the powerful force fields of parents, genetics and personality already at work. It starts with birth order, which determines play roles: the firstborn leader, the middle-child mediator and the rebellious youngest. These are roles that can stick for life.

Clinical psychologist Claire Cartwright says she has clients who believe, and it might not have been true, that they were treated differently from their siblings, that one child in the family was preferred over others. They are quite convinced that the parental judgments on them all those years ago were harsher, and that they were the ones who always got into trouble. Later, in the workplace, such a person might be particularly defensive, and so behave in a way more prone to attracting harsh judgements.

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However, the research shows that being Mummy or Daddy's favourite has its own traps. If you were the easy-going, co-operative child at home, you probably excelled at pleasing parents and, later, bosses. But you might, as an adult, find it hard to be assertive with authority figures and lack direction. On the other hand, the sibling who is disruptive and annoying as a child may be able to reinterpret that role later, turning those attention-seeking characteristics into strengths like determination and leadership.

How is it that full siblings, despite sharing DNA, can turn out so differently? One answer is that, in fact, each sibling grows up in a different family, a unique micro-culture. For example, the firstborn is, for a while, an only child, and therefore has a completely different experience of the parents than those born later. The parents themselves are growing up too, weathering hardship or good fortune, so one sibling might experience stability and closeness while another might be raised in the midst of crisis.

Of course, there are many positive aspects of sibling relationships. Annette Henderson, a lecturer in psychology, says firstborn children learn vocabulary more quickly than their siblings because they are not competing to spend one-on-one time with parents. But younger children in turn benefit from unintentional instruction from their bigger brothers and sisters, acquiring entire phrases and an understanding of social concepts such as politeness. Similarly, a Cambridge University study of 140 children found that even when there is a great deal of conflict, siblings will still create a rich world of play and make-believe that extends them developmentally. Love-hate relationships were common among the children, but even those who fought the most had as many positive interactions as the other sibling pairs. It is also true that children compete for parental attention by making themselves different from their brothers and sisters, particularly if they are close in age. A 2003 research paper studied adolescents from 185 families over two years, finding that those who changed, to differentiate themselves from their siblings, increased the amount of warmth they gained from parents, and also developed stronger personalities and a better sense of their own identity.

Another consideration is that many families today are smaller and more intimate than their historical counterparts. This may be advantageous because siblings tend to know each other better and remain lifelong friends compared to children from bigger or more widely spaced families, who perhaps lose touch with one another after leaving home. Then there was a 2010 American study which found that having a sister, whether younger or older, meant that 10- to 14-year-olds were less likely to feel lonely, unloved, self-conscious or fearful. The same study found that having a loving sibling of either gender promoted good deeds, such as helping a neighbor around the house or helping other children at school.

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Questions 27–30

Do the following statements agree with the views of the writer in the passage? Write **YES**, **NO** *or* **NOT GIVEN**.

27 Parents and siblings play equal roles in shaping people's adult personalities.

28 People's first social relationships tend to be with siblings of their own gender.

29 People's relationships with their siblings tend to receive less attention when they marry.

30 Parental 'basking' is advantageous for later siblings.

Questions 31–34

Choose the correct letter, **A**, **B**, **C** *or* **D**.

31 What point does the writer make about birth order in the third paragraph?

A Its role is underestimated by parents.
B It may shape the characteristics of adults.
C Its importance decreases as children grow up.
D It has more influence on personality than genetics.

32 What are we told about some of Claire Cartwright's clients?

A Their parents treated them fairly.
B They were treated harshly by their siblings.
C Their perceptions of childhood may be inaccurate.
D They have closer relations with their siblings as adults.

33 What is the writer's main point about siblings in the fifth paragraph?

A Parents tend to repeat their own parents' mistakes.
B Favored children are likely to make good leaders as adults.
C Negative characteristics in children can become positive in adults.
D Attention-seeking children are unlikely to please bosses in later life.

34 Which of the following best summarises the writer's argument in the sixth paragraph?

A Many children have a favourite parent.
B Parenting skills improve with later children.
C Siblings are born with different personalities.
D The family environment may change over time.

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Questions 35–40

Complete the summary using the list of words, **A–K**, *below.*

The Positive Aspects of Sibling Relationships

LIST OF WORDS

A parental love
B imaginative games
C physical development
D generous behaviour
E strong marriages
F greater individuality
G learning experiences
H career success
I closer relationships
J healthy competition
K mental well-being

Annette Henderson suggests that young children's interactions with older siblings involve (35) _____. Also, a Cambridge study found that siblings still enjoy (36) _____ even when they have a tendency to fight. Research conducted in 2003 suggests that children develop (37) _____ as a result of seeking attention. Another factor is the trend for smaller families, which may mean that today's siblings enjoy (38) _____ as adults. A 2010 American study linked having a sister with (39) _____ among children aged 10–14. Finally, having a sibling may promote (40) _____ according to the same study.

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PART TWO

Answer Keys

Complete answer keys for Tests 1–9 of Volume 9. Check your answers only after finishing each test.

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Answer Key

Reading Test 1 (Volume 9)

Passage 1 — Questions 1–13

1. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	all baobab species unique to island
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Of the eight known species, six are found only there, while a seventh has made its way across the Mozambique Channel from mainland Africa" — not all are unique to Madagascar

2. NOT GIVEN

QUESTION KEYWORD	first foreign botanists to visit
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the species is merely "named after" Adanson and Grandidier — no claim about them being the first foreign visitors

3. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	found in most areas
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"they only grow along the western margin of the island and not in the more populous central highlands"

4. TRUE

QUESTION KEYWORD	landscape result of agricultural development
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the surrounding landscape was created by humans... much of the Morondava plain was cleared for rice and sugar-cane fields"

5. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	Jim Bond certain about cause
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The exact cause of the falling baobabs is uncertain, but some people think..." — no certainty is expressed, by Bond or otherwise

6. FALSE

QUESTION KEYWORD	general agreement on reasons for falling
PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The exact cause of the falling baobabs is uncertain" — indicates disagreement/uncertainty, not consensus

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7. water

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the water used to irrigate the nearby fields is partly to blame"

8. cyclones

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Lone trees separated from the surrounding forest are also susceptible to cyclones"

9. farming

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The main threat to their survival is land clearance for farming"

10. logging

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Human disturbance in the forest, such as logging... promoting the rapid spread of shrubby undergrowth, which quickly fills in the bright forest gaps needed for baobab germination"

11. animals

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"dispersal is being limited by the absence of two large, now extinct animals"

12. maps

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"works closely with local people to search for, and create maps of baobab distribution"

13. book

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"He also plans to compile an illustrated children's book of the many local folk-tales about the tree"

Passage 2 — Questions 14–26

14. vii — An uncertain future

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	paragraph A describes coins possibly becoming obsolete, replaced by purely electronic money

15. xi — Significant records of past societies

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"future archaeologists will scrutinise coins in order to learn about their distant ancestors"

16. v — A simpler, more efficient way of trading

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"they no longer had to carry goods with them to barter"

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17. iv — Calculating what a coin was worth

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"coins could be weighed to determine the amount of metal they contained"; Archimedes' displacement method

18. ii — A form of regional promotion

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"coins... were a way of advertising the qualities of each particular city-state"

19. ix — Unchanging coins signalled trustworthiness

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"repeated virtually unaltered for many years... a uniform design implied integrity"

20. vi — Putting a face to famous historical names

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the features of many great Romans have survived and are known to modern generations"

21–22. A, C

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	A: "they are the work of anonymous craftsmen"; C: "the endless variety encountered in coins with the same designs"

23. civilisation / civilization

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Their civilisation, which was composed of dozens of city-states, was highly decentralised"

24. barter

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Before coins, trade was based on barter"

25. silver

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the discovery of silver mines on Greek territory"

26. inflation

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"so much gold from the New World was brought into their economy that it resulted in serious inflation"

Passage 3 — Questions 27–40

27. B

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"sets of two miniature white paper cups, labelled 304 and 305, were placed before five people"

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28. H

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"dampen the bitterness of drugs like antihistamines, antibiotics and other similar products"

29. E

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"varying capacities for tasting bitterness and the differences appear to be genetic"

30. F

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a group of receptors that captures the taste molecules... relayed via proteins known as G proteins"

31. C

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"bitterness is of special interest to the food industry because it is present in so many different types of food"

32. H

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"table salt could be replaced by another type of salt, potassium chloride... that bitter taste could be eliminated with a dose of AMP" — reduces sodium intake

33. D

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Every other species is averse to bitter because it means bad news. But we have learned to enjoy it."

34. naringin

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"juice packagers often select grapefruit with low naringin content"

35. poisonous

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"protect animals by letting them know when a plant may be poisonous"

36. genetic

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the differences appear to be genetic"

37. supertasters

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"are known as 'supertasters', are especially sensitive to these compounds"

38. taste buds

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"At the top is a group of receptors that captures the taste molecules"

39. **A**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The protein triggers a cascade of chemical reactions... delivers a signal to the brain that registers as bitter"

40. **C**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"AMP has no bitterness of its own... it attaches to bitter-taste receptors"; "that bitter taste could be eliminated with a dose of AMP"

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Answer Key

Reading Test 2 (Volume 9)

Passage 1 — Questions 1–13

1. father

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"William found a job in a cotton factory... Andrew Carnegie also worked in the cotton factory"

2. music

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"He became an avid reader, a theatergoer, and a lover of music"

3. secretary

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"made the eighteen-year-old his secretary"

4. steel

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Carnegie began to see that steel was eventually going to replace iron"

5. prices

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"continued building by cutting prices, driving out competitors"

6. banks

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"he obtained capital from profit, and when necessary from banks"

7. projects

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Carnegie planned new projects and the improvement of existing plants"

8. TRUE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Triumphant Democracy... pointed out what he thought were the advantages of life in the United States over the unequal societies of Britain and other European countries"

9. TRUE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"automated many of the mill's operations, cutting down the number of workers that were needed"

10. FALSE

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Carnegie believed that workers had a right to join unions"

11. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Carnegie was criticized for his lack of action" — no mention of blaming Frick specifically

12. FALSE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"He refused to enter into any agreements with other companies"

13. FALSE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"built some three thousand public libraries all over the English-speaking world"

Passage 2 — Questions 14–26

14. E

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The success of translation depends on the purpose for which it was made, which in turn reflects the needs of the people for whom it was made"

15. H

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Some countries view translation as a menial, clerical task... while others regard it as a major intellectual discipline"

16. semantic equivalence

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The aim of translation is to provide semantic equivalence between source and target language"

17. purpose

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The success of translation depends on the purpose for which it was made"

18. stylistic

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"A translation of a scientific article requires careful attention to meaning but little attention to stylistic features"

19. content

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"dubbed film script will warrant scrupulous care over the synchronisation of lip movements, often at the expense of content"

20. E — pragmatic

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"A pragmatic translation emphasises accuracy and knowledge of the subject"

21. B — ethnographic

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Ethnographic or sociolinguistic translations aim to pay full attention to the cultural backgrounds"

22. D — literal

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"In a literal translation the linguistic structure of the source text is followed, but is normalised according to the rules of the target language"

23. C — free

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"In a free translation the linguistic structure of the source language is ignored, and an equivalent is found based on the meaning"

24–26. B, D, F

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	B: "The same special awareness needs to be present for the target language"; D: "there is no such thing as a best translation"; F: "reads as if it were written originally in the target language"

Passage 3 — Questions 27–40

27. D — wood

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"there were no forests on the island, he could not comprehend how people devoid of heavy timber could build"

28. C — boats

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Their canoes were leaky and frail, not the sort of ocean-going craft that could survive a three-week sea journey"

29. A — poverty

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the islanders were living in extremely poor conditions"

30. B — agriculture

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"there was no cultivation of crops"

31. YES

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"his theory appealed to those fascinated with space travel" (for a short period)

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32. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no mention of archaeologists removing artefacts

33. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no duration given for smallpox's effects

34. NO

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"There is no doubt that the island was once covered in palm trees"

35. YES

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"rats found their way to the island, although exactly how is a matter of debate"

36. C

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"they needed to cut large logs for the construction of long 'canoe ladders' to carry them to the coast" — a transportation method

37. B

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the first people to arrive came around AD1200, about 400 years later than other scientists have suggested"

38. A

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"almost all of the palm seed shells discovered on the island were found to have been gnawed by rats which would have made them unable to germinate"

39. A

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"He refutes the arguments of the sceptics... he maintains that Hunt and Lipo are ignoring... evidence"

40. B

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	the article presents Diamond's, Hunt and Lipo's, and Flenley's competing theories without endorsing one

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Answer Key

Reading Test 3 (Volume 9)

Passage 1 — Questions 1–13

1. TRUE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a growing number of researchers seek to understand the biology and complex behavior"

2. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Strauss expresses surprise at how little giraffes have been studied in the wild, but no opinion on zoos is given

3. FALSE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"in the past 15 years, the population has fallen some 40 percent"

4. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Female giraffes can live 20 years or more" — no comparison to male lifespan is made

5. TRUE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"mothers will fight valiantly to keep their young alive - kicking forward and backward"

6. FALSE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"should a dominant older bull come into view, the younger males instantly try to make themselves look small and innocent"

7. TRUE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Clashes have been witnessed between adults when each bull repeatedly 'necks' the other"

8. camouflage

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"dark patches separated by light hair, which serves as camouflage"

9. hands

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"almost as humans would grab with their hands"

10. birth

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"giraffe mothers would have a difficult time giving birth to young with longer necks"

11. veins

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The outside of a giraffe's veins are extremely thick, to prevent blood leaking into surrounding tissue"

12. heart

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a giraffe does not have an unusually large heart. It is half a percent of body mass"

13. signals

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"signals from the nerves travel at about the same speed... Given the greater distance they have to travel"

Passage 2 — Questions 14–26

14. iv — The low priority given to making buildings healthy for users

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"builders in general have paid little attention to the health aspects of indoor spaces"

15. viii — The financial benefits of efficient workplaces

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"$40 per person, per year, compared with a $6,500 increase in employee productivity"

16. vi — Workers were assessed outside of their usual workplace

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"24 office workers... came to the lab and performed their regular work"

17. iii — The assessment of workplaces in several locations

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"compared test scores of 109 people working in 10 buildings... in two buildings in each of five cities"

18. i — The effects of a new environmentally friendly building on the people who work there

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Hillman Hall was designed with the highest environmental and energy standards... Eyler conducted a pre-test... and a post-test"

19. v — Achieving design efficiency by involving a range of specialists

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Administrators, public health faculty and architects worked together"

20. B

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Zimring: "If these findings are replicated... they could lead to designs that... [promote] better health and performance"

21. C

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	MacNaughton: "other factors, such as how someone feels about their working environment, may also play a part"

22. D

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Eyler's results: "people were more likely to take part in spontaneous collaborations in the new space"

23. B

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Zimring notes "indoor air quality can significantly lower cognitive performance"

24. sustainability

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Syracuse Center of Excellence, a US research organization devoted to studying and developing sustainability"

25. supervision

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"performed their regular work under minimal supervision"

26. mayor

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"scenarios that mimic real-life situations, such as running a city as a mayor"

Passage 3 — Questions 27–40

27. D

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"by 1300 it appears there was a toy industry in England... taxed at a halfpenny each"

28. D

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Gerald of Wales recalls how he and his brothers built towns, palaces, churches and monasteries from sand"

29. E

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"archery is an example of a sport encouraged by adults"

30. F

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"six months after King Richard II had been overthrown by Henry IV, the children of London gathered together and chose themselves kings"

31. B

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Forty years ago, the French historian Philippe Aries argued... that childhood in the Middle Ages did not exist"

32. I — children's gang warfare

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"In 1400... the children of London gathered together and chose themselves kings... made war upon each other"

33. J — a description of seasonal activities

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"In 1518, the poet Alexander Barclay records children playing with tops in March... summer... autumn"

34. F — dolls taxed in England

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"in 1582, taxed at a halfpenny each"

35. C — poem about value of games

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Sir Henry Newbolt's celebrated cricket poem Vitai Lampada (1908)"

36. NO

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"These questions can be answered from a rich body of evidence including actual toys... pictures... literary sources"

37. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"by 1300 it appears there was a toy industry in England" — no claim about most toys being imported before 1300

38. YES

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Children shared in the adult round of religious festivals, but had their own observances as well, semi-detached from their elders"

39. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no mention of children making presents for parents

40. YES

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the relationship between adults and children in medieval society was, in major respects, a modern one"

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Answer Key

Reading Test 4 (Volume 9)

Passage 1 — Questions 1–13

1. need

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"allocated by the headman or headwoman of a village to people of either sex according to need"

2. ashes

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"citemene, a system whereby crops are grown on the ashes of tree branches"

3. cassava

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The diverse sequence ends with the vegetable cassava"

4. series of ridges

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"When forest is not available... a series of ridges is built"

5. houses

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"mango, guava and oil-palm trees are often grown around houses"

6. A — Fish

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Fishing has always been a far more remunerative activity in Luapula... being the one substantial source of cash"

7. B — Goats

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"most people keep freely roaming chickens and goats... may also be occasionally slaughtered for ceremonies"

8. C — Oxen

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"only small numbers of cattle or oxen are kept in the province owing to the prevalence of the tsetse fly"

9. A — Fish

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Much fish is dried for sale to areas away from the main waterways"

10. TRUE

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"absence of animal power for pulling machinery greatly limits people's ability to plough... by hand-hoeing"

11. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no mention of children's labour

12. FALSE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"These animals are not a standard part of most people's diet"

13. C

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"neither the fisheries nor the woodlands of Luapula are capable... of supporting the expanding population in a sustainable manner"

Passage 2 — Questions 14–26

14. E

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"made a comparison of recordings of 60 healthy newborns... researchers were at the ready with their microphones"

15. D

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"German and French babies were selected for the comparison because the differences in the intonation shapes... are particularly pronounced"

16. F

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Newborns are probably highly motivated to imitate their mother's behaviour in order to attract her and foster bonding and therefore physical nourishment"

17. B

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"babies had hoods with electrodes put on their heads, and had recordings of different intonation patterns played to them"

18. A

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"they cannot hear the actual words. It is a bit like holding your head under water"

19. F

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The melody of the German babies' screams usually began loudly... while the French babies more often screamed with a rising melody contour"

20. B

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Williams: "If a fire siren sounded different every day, we would not even recognise it!"

21. C

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Meade: "melodic patterns practised in crying are building blocks for eventual sound production... up to the first words and sentences"

22. B

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Williams: "among baby chimpanzees, the 'crying melody' is closely associated with the build-up and reduction of pressure in the lungs, and is not generated by a mental process"

23. A

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Finlayson: "The mother's voice in particular is sensed early on"

24. accents

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"probably cannot distinguish between the accents of Welsh and Northern Scottish people"

25. brainwaves

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The children's brainwaves reacted to the differences even when they were asleep"

26. signal

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a baby's cry was just a signal of alarm to call its mother"

Passage 3 — Questions 27–40

27. NO

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"historians have asked the question: How and why did..."

28. YES

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"these historians had little more direct evidence of the earliest phases of Rome's history than modern writers have, and in some ways perhaps not as much"

29. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"tell us a good deal about how the Romans saw their city, their values, and their failings" — no claim of unrealistic positivity

30. NO

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"they tell us very little indeed about what they claim to inform us about... what earliest Rome was actually like"

31. YES

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Rome was already a very old city by 63 BCE... One fact is obvious"

32. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no mention of opposition to excavations

33. A

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"We have little idea of the nature of these huts... But we can fill in some of the gaps if we look just outside Rome" (Fidenae)

34. D

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"foundations... obliterated much of what then lay beneath the surface; the cellars of grand Renaissance houses cut through even more ancient remains"

35. B

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"to produce a rough chronological scheme covering the period from around 1000 to 600 BCE"

36. D

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Recent scientific methods... have suggested that they are all too 'young', by as much as a hundred years... If anything, Rome appears to be getting older"

37. F

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"seeking out clues in the Latin language... that might point back to features of earliest Rome"

38. C

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Beneath the Forum itself... lie the remains of an early cemetery"

39. A

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"made of wood and rammed earth - a construction method still utilised up to the present day"

40. D

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the occasional presence on graves of Greek ceramics (whose dating is better...)... to produce a rough chronological scheme"

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Answer Key

Reading Test 5 (Volume 9)

Passage 1 — Questions 1–13

1. FALSE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"No drawings or descriptions of any tennis-like games have been discovered"

2. TRUE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"French monks were the first to play a basic game of handball"; "game of the hand or palm"

3. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	only a comparison to table tennis paddles is made, with no date given for table tennis' development

4. FALSE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The game, which remained exclusive to the upper classes, gained more popularity over the 14th and 15th centuries"

5. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no size comparison between indoor and outdoor courts is given

6. TRUE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"both the pope and the French king tried to ban it"

7. surfaces

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the ball can be bounced off any of the surfaces, some of which are slanted at odd angles"

8. net

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The net is just over 1.5 metres high at each end, but drops to just under a metre in the middle"

9. rubber

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"development of rubber tennis balls. During the 1850s, players began to experiment with these new balls"

10. rules

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"had the idea of devising rules, which he published"

11. equipment

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"introduced standardised equipment... which he patented and sold in sets"

12. shape

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"his original court had the shape of an hourglass"

13. tournament

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"A major tennis tournament took place for the first time in Wimbledon"

Passage 2 — Questions 14–26

14. v — Ray's appreciation of his contemporary academic culture

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a profound revolution in the way people interacted with nature... that we now call science"

15. iii — A succession of academic achievements

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"appointed Lecturer in Greek in 1651, Lecturer in Mathematics in 1653, and Lecturer in Humanities in 1655"

16. ix — A change of direction for Ray

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Ray also seems to have developed the interest to which he would devote the rest of his life"

17. iv — Ray's informal tuition

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"first-year students at Trinity College were able to identify the plants... taught (unofficially)... by Ray"

18. i — Ray's account of his working methods

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"I had first to become familiar with the literature, to compare the plants that I found with the pictures..."

19. viii — A description of the content of Ray's first book

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"gave the names of plants found in the area around Cambridge and included information about where they grew"

20. vii — Plans for a bold new project

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"began to imagine a more comprehensive investigation of nature… classify living things"

21. **revolution**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a profound revolution in the way people interacted with nature"

22. **science**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a new philosophy, based on experiment and observation of the real world, that we now call science"

23. **illness**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"he suffered an illness in his early twenties, and was advised to take long walks"

24. **students**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the first-year students at Trinity College were able to identify the plants… taught… by Ray"

25–26. **C, D**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	C: Samuel Covell "had graduated from Cambridge University in 1600"; D: "His father was a village blacksmith… his mother was also a respected member of the community"

Passage 3 — Questions 27–40

27. **C**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Ronalds wrote to Lord Melville… to offer him his telegraphic system" — letter dated 11 July 1816

28. **H**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"In 1870… he was knighted by Queen Victoria"

29. **E**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"in 1837 they developed the Wheatstone-Cooke five-needle telegraph. The pair patented their design in the same year"

30. **B**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"In 1814, de Luc encouraged Ronalds to start work on this new discipline"

31. **D**

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"in a small pamphlet published in 1823, he described his invention and listed some of its potential uses"

32. letters and numbers

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a revolving disc, on which letters and numbers were engraved"

33. glass tubes

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the wire was encased in glass tubes and buried in the ground"

34. 800 km

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"his invention was capable of carrying messages some 800 km"

35. frictional electricity

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Ralph Wedgwood had offered the Admiralty a similar type of telegraph based on frictional electricity"

36. G

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"saw the potential of a rapid communication system for the growing number of private railway companies"

37. E

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"telegraphs of any kind are wholly unnecessary, and NO other than the one now in use will be adopted"

38. C

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The system was slow and depended on the two dials staying in step"

39. A

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"de Luc encouraged Ronalds to start work on this new discipline"

40. F

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"A similar system was developed independently by Charles Brooke, but the British Association of Meteorologists confirmed Ronalds's priority"

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Answer Key

Reading Test 6 (Volume 9)

Passage 1 — Questions 1–13

1. TRUE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"For the past decade, Dr Cindy Engel... has been collating examples of self-medicating behaviour"

2. FALSE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"generally regarded with some scepticism by other animal behaviourists"

3. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no mention of a medical team assisting Karesh

4. TRUE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"if healthy wild animals are brought into captivity, their health often deteriorates"

5. pith

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"would dose themselves with the pith... of a plant called Vernonia"

6. terpenes

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"This plant produces poisonous chemicals called terpenes"

7. alkaloid

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the macaws that had eaten the clay had 60% less alkaloid in their bloodstreams"

8. drug

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"His (and everybody else's) assumption was that Aspilia released a drug"

9. unpleasant

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"wrinkling their noses as they swallowed these leaves, suggesting the experience was unpleasant"

10. geophagy

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"consume dirt - a behaviour known as geophagy"

11. salt

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"soil supplies minerals such as salt"

12. detoxify

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"helps to detoxify the defensive poisons"

13. tablets

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"frequently sell tablets made of different sorts of clays"

Passage 2 — Questions 14–26

14. vii — Some occupations involve little or no interesting conversation

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"characterised by a lack of conversation or by meaningless small talk"

15. iv — A study that categorised types of spoken exchanges

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"catalogued each overheard conversation as either 'small talk' or 'substantive'"

16. i — How sounds and physical contact strengthen social connections

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"tested the relationship between vocal exchanges and grooming in lemurs"

17. iii — An experiment that led to surprising results

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Participants had predicted precisely the opposite outcome"

18. ix — A range of common situations that were enhanced by small talk

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	coffee shop, art gallery, and laboratory waiting-room examples

19. v — The personality types that find small talk more difficult

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"'less curious about all aspects of life' had trouble getting a conversation going"

20. D

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"people who had a social interaction with a server... felt better emotionally than people who were in a rush"

21. **A**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"people who had more substantive conversations were more likely to say they were feeling happy and fulfilled"

22. **B**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"reserve their call-and-response conversations, equivalent to human chitchat"

23. **E**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"'curious' needed no help transforming conversations... into other areas of conversation"

24. **commuters**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"other commuters who usually took the same train to work every day"

25. **paintings**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the visitors felt happier and more connected to the paintings"

26. **topics**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"supplied with topics that encouraged people to open up"

Passage 3 — Questions 27–40

27. **ix — Optimism about transforming the country**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"intended to turn the weak and undeveloped country into a powerful, modern, industrial nation... Unlimited enthusiasm"

28. **vii — Inspiration from abroad**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"intrigued by the ideas of Taylor, the American management expert... great admirers of Ford's assembly line"

29. **iii (given as example)**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	reduced working day (better conditions) offset by a three-shift, six-day system (worse conditions)

30. **i — A decision for factories to operate seven days a week**

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"so that the machines could operate to their full capacity every day of the week"

31. xi — Pros and cons of the continuous working week

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"stressed the material and cultural benefits... The only objection concerned the family"

32. iv — Not consistently introduced everywhere

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"some factories operating five-, six- and seven-day weeks at the same time"

33. x — The failure of factories to achieve expected improvements

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the new week was far from having the vaunted effect on production"

34. ii — The end of two short-lived schemes

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Both were finally abandoned in 1940... The experiment had failed"

35. C

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"time and motion studies had discovered ways of streamlining effort so that every worker could produce the maximum"

36. B

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"so that the machines could operate to their full capacity every day of the week"

37. A

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The only objection concerned the family"

38. Taylor

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Lenin had already been intrigued by the ideas of Taylor"

39. Larin

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the economist Larin came up with an idea for even greater efficiency"

40. colour-coding

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"each assigned a colour... This colour-coding was a valuable device"

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Answer Key

Reading Test 7 (Volume 9)

Passage 1 — Questions 1–13

1. TRUE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"supplemented the diet of sheep in the Orkneys... since Neolithic times, roughly 5000 years ago"

2. FALSE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"seaweed was already such a key part of people's regular diet"

3. TRUE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"these findings suggest that women... also played an important part in the provision of food"

4. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"In 1800, Norway exported 1500 tonnes of potash" — no claim it was the largest export

5. TRUE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"hardly anyone has heard of Dr Drew-Baker in the UK, but she is known as the 'Mother of the Sea' in Japan"

6. typhoons

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a series of typhoons combined with increased pollution"

7. laver

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"studying a seaweed called laver, which is the Welsh equivalent of nori"

8. kelp

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"his work on kelp, a large brown seaweed"

9. fishermen

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"New England fishermen whose livelihoods were threatened"

10. chemicals

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"ability to absorb a number of environmentally unfriendly chemicals"

11. markets

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the lack of markets and the relative expense of European production"

12. jobs

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"generating 50 million jobs in the process"

13. vehicles

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"As a biofuel for vehicles, it could also replace about 1.5% of the fossil fuels"

Passage 2 — Questions 14–26

14. E

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Specialists have long debated which country was the homeland of the Indo-Europeans"

15. A

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"an imposing statue of Mars, the Roman god of war"

16. G

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"She had less confidence in the dating method"

17. B

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Breton, a Celtic tongue carried to Brittany in France by emigrants from Cornwall"

18. C

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Because languages change so fast, historical linguists have little faith in language trees"

19. A

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"similar to historical linguists, many of whom restrict their research to how words in only one single language have changed"

20. D

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"language changes in an irregular way based on social factors like the size of the speaker's group"

21. **A**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Celtic became a language in its own right and entered the British Isles much earlier than supposed"

22. **C**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"does seem to vindicate Renfrew's archaeological idea that the Indo-European languages were spread by farmers"

23. **Gaulish**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the words were in Gaulish"

24. **Latin**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"their language, Latin, and its successor languages displaced Celtic"

25. **divergence**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the divergence between the mainland European and British versions of Gaelic took place in 3200 BC"

26. **irregular**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"language changes in an irregular way based on social factors"

Passage 3 — Questions 27–40

27. **D**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"companies that successfully introduce new products are more likely to flourish than those that don't"

28. **D**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"But surely that's too simple an explanation... To understand why new products fail we must delve into the psychology"

29. **A**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"consumers evaluate new products relative to the products they already own"

30. **B**

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the Sellers always demanded at least twice as much to give up the mugs as the Choosers would pay"

31. B

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"gave a second group the coffee mugs but later allowed each student to exchange their mugs for a chocolate bar"

32. C

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"only 11% of the students with mugs and 10% of those with chocolate bars wanted to exchange their products"

33. B

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"develop innovations that are objectively superior to existing products, and consumers will have sufficient incentive to purchase them"

34. A

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"research into the reasons why individuals deviate from rational economic behavior"

35. D

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"people evaluate the attractiveness of an alternative based not on its objective... value, but on its subjective or perceived value"

36. NO

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the theory has one major flaw: it fails to capture the psychological biases that affect decision-making"

37. YES

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"our desire to keep what we have is far greater than our desire to gain something new"

38. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"They're convinced that the product works" — belief in function, not explicitly stated as belief in commercial success

39. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no mention of time spent perfecting products

40. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"product champions" are described as believers in the product, not defined by sales success

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Answer Key

Reading Test 8 (Volume 9)

Passage 1 — Questions 1–13

1. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no mention of volunteer status for RFDS doctors

2. FALSE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"RFDS dentists might only visit a community once every few months, or sometimes once per year"

3. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no mention of a dental nurse accompanying dentists

4. TRUE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"RFDS dentists need to be 'all-rounders'. They need to be able to do all kinds of dental procedures"

5. FALSE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"people living in these areas also receive less education about good dental hygiene than their city counterparts"

6. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	passage mentions education on "tooth brushing and flossing", not eating habits

7. TRUE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"City dwellers in Australia use water supplies that have been fluoridated, and their rates of tooth decay are lower because of this"

8. computers

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"computers for keeping track of patients' treatments"

9. space

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the small planes that transport dentists have limited space"

10. dentures

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"dentures... it is not practical to make dentures available"

11–12. **toothpaste, toothbrushes**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"toothpaste and toothbrushes can be more expensive in outback areas... the RFDS supplies these"

13. **mouthguards**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The RFDS also provides mouthguards for young sports players"

Passage 2 — Questions 14–26

14. **vii — How involvement with art affects well-being and attitudes**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"active art experiences benefit all age groups... improves motivation and attitudes"

15. **viii — How art makes communities safer and more vital**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"effective in reducing community problems related to delinquent behavior and truancy"

16. **iv — How art can be made accessible to the public**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"communities are finding many ways to ensure that the public is provided with opportunities to experience art"

17. **v — Developing a model to explain the lack of participation in art**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"RAND Corporation... developed 'A Behavior Model of the Participant Decision'"

18. **i — Interpreting the research behind who is participating in art activities**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The RAND findings reveal that the disinclined perceive themselves as being uncomfortable"

19. **iii — Two opportunities for getting kids involved in art activities**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the Boys and Girls Clubs of America, which offer two innovative programs"

20. **A**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"reducing community problems related to delinquent behavior and truancy in youth (Spector 2000)"

21. **D**

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Art-related tourism generates tourists and revenue... (Hughes 2000)"

22. **C**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"considered more livable because they are attractive to businesses and industry (Riley 2002)"

23. **B**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"can provide the benefits of discovery, stimulation and relaxation (Oliphant 2000)"

24. **attire**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"constrained by particular barriers such as cost, time, and proper attire"

25. **rates**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"a strong relationship exists between childhood and adult art participation rates"

26. **recognition**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"opportunity to achieve personal growth and receive artistic recognition"

Passage 3 — Questions 27–40

27. **NO**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"It is hardly surprising, then, that this results in a flexible, wide-ranging notion of landscape"

28. **NOT GIVEN**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no mention of rejected Australian suggestions

29. **YES**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"it was inevitable during Australian art's formative years that it would reflect Britain's devotion to the beloved landscape"

30. **YES**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the Academy is nevertheless embracing the peculiarities of Australian art"; "how Australian art develops a real distinctiveness"

31. **NO**

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"there can be little denying that British landscape painting is still relevant to a current generation of Australian practitioners"

32. C

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"there is a suggestion that British artistic values have directed this exhibition"

33. B

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the underlying rules for the selection of works seemed to have been so conservative"

34. A

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"It is his acknowledgment of landscape... tradition, coloured by Gladwell's own individualism... I wanted to make it personal"

35. C

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"I felt it was most accurate to be seen as part of Australian art history, rather than a separate exhibition"

36. A

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"China is the most important art market in the world... The world has changed"

37. F

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the Academy is nevertheless embracing the peculiarities of Australian art"

38. E

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the influence of English, French or German art is much more evident in the early periods"

39. A

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"interested in Turner and the idea of atmosphere affecting vision"

40. C

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"these works warrant a prominent position because they were 'first'"; "part of Australian art history"

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Answer Key

Reading Test 9 (Volume 9)

Passage 1 — Questions 1–13

1. TRUE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"grown... particularly in soil that is both sandy and acidic"

2. TRUE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The clay bottom acts as a protective barrier, preventing harmful substances from entering the pond"

3. FALSE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"developed methods of drying and combining cranberries... to extend their usefulness during months when fresh plants were scarce"

4. TRUE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"crushed fruit was applied to sores and minor wounds"

5. FALSE

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Rather than attempting to transplant European varieties, the newcomers adopted the native species"

6. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no mention of Hall growing other fruit crops

7. NOT GIVEN

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no timeframe given for adoption of Hall's methods by others

8. flood

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"farmers often choose to flood the bogs, forming a protective layer"

9. drainage

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"particles work into the bed and improve overall drainage"

10. air

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"so that air can move through the site more freely"

11. water

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"controlled water applications may be used at vulnerable times to shield budding shoots from sudden frosts"

12. maintenance

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"growers perform routine maintenance on channels, pumps and irrigation lines and take steps to reduce pest pressure"

13. weed

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"Farmers inspect beds for any sign of weed emergence"

Passage 2 — Questions 14–26

14. F

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"White chocolate contains no cocoa solids, milk chocolate contains relatively small amounts... dark chocolate contains a much higher percentage"

15. B

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"these compounds have anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties and may help protect against cardiovascular disease"

16. E

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"certain groups, particularly overweight individuals, may not receive the same protective effects"

17. G

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"I put cocoa powder in my smoothies for an added boost of flavor"

18. C

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"people may digest cocoa differently. Variations in gut bacteria can influence how flavanols are processed"

19. A

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Hultin: "Including different colors of fruits, vegetables, whole grains and beans is the best way to gain access to fiber"

20. B

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"European Food Safety Authority approved the claim... the cost involved in future medical treatment may be less"

21. **D**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	EPIC-Norfolk: "unlikely to do much to reduce risk of cardiovascular disease compared with taking medicine"

22. **C**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	Sesso: "they have yet to determine how much people need to consume to reap benefits"

23. **compounds**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"cocoa is broken down into smaller chemical compounds"

24. **benefits**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"dark chocolate should in theory confer greater benefits than milk chocolate"

25. **fats**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"chocolate products are typically high in calories and fats"

26. **fiber / fibre**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"the best way to gain access to fiber that could support health"

Passage 3 — Questions 27–40

27. **NO**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"even more influential in determining what kind of adult we will become are our brothers and sisters"

28. **NOT GIVEN**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	no mention of gender-matching in first social relationships

29. **NOT GIVEN**

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"less emotionally intense than the bonds we form with our spouses" — no claim about reduced attention after marriage

30. **YES**

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PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"parental 'basking'... associated with more positive parenting of younger children, who display fewer behavioural problems"

31. B

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"birth order, which determines play roles... These are roles that can stick for life"

32. C

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"she has clients who believe, and it might not have been true, that they were treated differently"

33. C

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"disruptive and annoying as a child may be able to reinterpret that role later, turning... characteristics into strengths"

34. D

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"The parents themselves are growing up too... one sibling might experience stability... while another might be raised in the midst of crisis"

35. G — learning experiences

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"younger children... benefit from unintentional instruction... acquiring entire phrases and an understanding of social concepts"

36. B — imaginative games

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"siblings will still create a rich world of play and make-believe"

37. F — greater individuality

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"those who changed, to differentiate themselves from their siblings... developed stronger personalities and a better sense of their own identity"

38. I — closer relationships

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"siblings tend to know each other better and remain lifelong friends"

39. K — mental well-being

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"having a sister... meant that 10- to 14-year-olds were less likely to feel lonely, unloved, self-conscious or fearful"

40. D — generous behaviour

PASSAGE EVIDENCE	"having a loving sibling of either gender promoted good deeds, such as helping a neighbor... or helping other children"

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